

Post-doctoral: Simulation and measurement of road surface
optical properties

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Abstract

Abstract— The spectral reflectance properties of road surfaces play a critical role in enhancing lighting efficiency, reducing environmental impacts, and supporting the development of advanced mobility systems. In this work, we present a novel method for measuring the spectral BRDF of road surfaces across a broad wavelength range (350–2500 nm). The approach is based on the gonireflectometer developed by Cerema for photometric BRDF measurements, adapted for spectral analysis. Validation of the method is performed first using a Spectralon reference material with known diffuse reflectance properties, and then results are cross-validated with measurements conducted by Université Gustave Eiffel. To illustrate the method’s applicability, two road formulations (F2 and F3) and their individual components, provided by Spie Batignolles, were analyzed as representative examples. A total of 1728 measurements were performed for each sample, covering a wide range of illumination and observation geometries. The results show that the type of binder has a pronounced effect on the BRDF behavior of multi-component road surfaces, whereas aggregate size contributes only minor spectral variations, primarily in the specular reflection direction. These findings could provide a comprehensive dataset and a methodological framework for future research on modeling the BRDF of multi-material road surfaces. Such models can combine the spectral characteristics of individual components through linear or nonlinear approaches.

Key words— Spectral BRDF, reflectance, solar albedo, reflectance of road surface, BRDF models, BRDF measurements, gonireflectometer, goniospectroradiometer,

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Chapter 1

Introduction

1.1 Context and objectives

In our daily lives, we have seen a variety of road surfaces, including bituminous (or asphalt) roads, concrete roads, earthen roads, gravel roads, and murram roads. Among these, bituminous roads are the most commonly seen in our daily transportation due to their practicality, wear resistance and robustness. In the design and operation of mobility systems, many challenges, e.g. climate imperatives, the rise of active modes of transport, and the arrival of autonomous vehicles, require us to rethink a number of practices. In this context, the optical properties of road surface play a fundamental role in optimizing the energy consumption of public lighting installations [1], reduce light pollution [2], control urban temperature [3], and consider perception of road markings [4]. In favor of these issues, it becomes necessary to know the optical properties of road surface or be able to anticipate them when creating a surfacing or predicting their evolution over time. Consequently, this requires conducting a significant number of simulations or measurements.

When discussing optical properties of road surface, both the Bidirectional Reflectance Distribution Function (BRDF) and solar albedo are essential. The former provides detailed directional information, describing the angular distribution of reflected light based on the angle of incoming light and the viewing angle [5]. It captures how surface roughness, texture, and material composition affect light reflection, affecting the visibility of the road and markings [6]. The latter gives an overall

measure of reflected energy, representing the total fraction of incoming solar energy reflected by the road surface, without regard to direction [7]. Road surface with higher solar albedo reduces heat absorption by reflecting more sunlight back into the atmosphere, lowering cooling demands in nearby buildings and contributing to mitigate the damage on road materials.

To know these two optical properties, it requires to perform extensive measurements or simulations. The former are usually costly, not only in terms of instrumentation but also in the time required to measure it. Although launching simulations can address these limits, it needs to find an appropriate reflectance model which perfectly fit the measured. As known, roads are usually composed of multiple materials, such as bitumen, different aggregates, filler.

1.2 Mission

To achieve the objective, the mission follows 5 steps:

1. Build several single-component road samples and measure their BRDF;
2. Fit the measured BRDF of each single-component road sample using existing BRDF models;
3. Build several multi-component road samples and measure their BRDF;
4. Explore and develop the method to combine the BRDFs of each single-component to fit the measurement of multi-component road samples;
5. Estimate the solar albedo using BRDF.

1.3 Report organization

This report is structured into the following chapters:

Chapter 2

Optical properties of road surface

2.1 Basic concepts

To provide a clear understanding of the optical properties of road surface, the fundamental terminologies are introduced in this section.

2.1.1 Radiometric quantities

Radiometric quantities provide a way to measure and describe the behavior of radiant energy in terms of light interaction with road surface. They include flux, radiant intensity, irradiance and radiance.

Flux F , is the most fundamental quantity in radiometry [5]. It is also called radiant power, which measures the amount of light that hits a surface over a finite area from all directions per unit time. For a given amount of radiated energy Q at a time duration t , the flux F is expressed as:

$$F(t) = \frac{dQ}{dt} \quad (2.1)$$

As Q is expressed in Joules (J), the unit of F is watts ($W = J \cdot s^{-1}$)

Radiant intensity I , is a correlated measure of flux. It represents the intensity of flux per unit solid angle which is propagate towards some specific direction (θ, φ) toward the the infinitesimal

solid angle $d\vec{\omega}$ [8]. Thus, it can be expressed in terms of flux:

$$I(t, \theta, \varphi) = \frac{dF(t)}{d\vec{\omega}} = \frac{dF(t)}{\sin \theta d\theta d\varphi} \quad (2.2)$$

Notice that the unit of solid angle is the steradian $[sr]$, so the unit of radiant intensity is $[W \cdot sr^{-1}]$.

Irradiance E , is another correlated measure of flux in terms of surface area. Different from radiant intensity, it captures the integration over the entire hemisphere Ω of the incident light arriving at a unit surface $ds(p)$ centered on the point p . Essentially, it measure the amount of radiated energy strike a unit area per unit time:

$$E(p, t) = \frac{dF(t)}{ds(p)} \quad (2.3)$$

Its unit is $[W \cdot m^{-2}]$

Radiance L , measures the amount of incident light arriving at a unit surface $ds(p)$ centered on p from a unit solid angle $d\vec{\omega}$ per unit time t . It can be considered as a correlated measure of radiant intensity per unit area or irradiance per unit solid angle:

$$L(p, t, \theta, \varphi) = \frac{d^2F(t)}{|\vec{\omega} \cdot \vec{n}| d\vec{\omega} ds(p)} = \frac{dI(t, \theta, \varphi)}{\cos \theta ds(p)} = \frac{dE(p, t)}{\sin \theta d\theta d\varphi} \quad (2.4)$$

The product term $\cos \theta ds(p)$ represents the projection of the unit surface $ds(p)$ onto the direction $\vec{\omega}$. According to its definition, the unit of $L(p, t, \theta, \varphi)$ is $[W \cdot m^{-2} \cdot sr^{-1}]$.

2.1.2 Spectral radiometry

In the previous section, the definitions of radiometric quantities are given without considering the wavelength. In order to describe the spectral distribution of a radiation, the spectral radiometric quantities are introduced, including spectral flux, spectral intensity, spectral irradiance and spectral radiance.

Spectral flux F_λ , is defined as the flux per unit wavelength and expressed in $[W \cdot nm^{-1}]$:

$$F_\lambda(t) = \frac{dF(t)}{d\lambda} \quad (2.5)$$

Spectral intensity I_λ , is the radiant intensity per unit wavelength and expressed in $[W \cdot sr^{-1} \cdot nm^{-1}]$:

$$I_\lambda(t, \theta, \varphi) = \frac{dI(t, \theta, \varphi)}{d\lambda} \quad (2.6)$$

Spectral irradiance E_λ , is irradiance per unit wavelength and expressed in $[W \cdot m^{-2} \cdot nm^{-1}]$:

$$E_\lambda(p, t) = \frac{E(p, t)}{d\lambda} \quad (2.7)$$

Spectral radiance L_λ , is defined as the radiance per unit wavelength and expressed in $[W \cdot m^{-2} \cdot sr^{-1} \cdot nm^{-1}]$:

$$L_\lambda(p, t, \theta, \varphi) = \frac{dL(p, t, \theta, \varphi)}{d\lambda} \quad (2.8)$$

The measurement of spectral quantities are conducted with instruments such as spectrophotometers which analyze the radiation in adjacent and narrow spectral bands [8]. When analyzing radiation over a broader wavelength range $[\lambda_1, \lambda_2]$, the total measured flux can be calculated by integrating the spectral flux density across the specified waveband. This process accounts for the contribution of all individual wavelengths within the range, providing a cumulative representation of the flux. The computation is expressed as:

$$F(\lambda_1, \lambda_2) = \int_{\lambda_1}^{\lambda_2} F_\lambda d\lambda \quad (2.9)$$

2.1.3 Photometry

To characterize light perception by human eyes, photometry is thus introduced. It relies on similar spectral radiometry quantities [8], by weighting the spectral quantities by spectral luminous efficiency function $V(\lambda)$. The corresponding visual quantities referring to flux, irradiance and radiance are luminous flux, illuminance and luminance, respectively.

Luminous flux F_v , is the measure of the perceived power of visible light. It is expressed in lumens (lm).

Illuminance E_v , represents the luminous flux incident per unit area on a surface at a given point O [9]. It is measured in *lux* (lumens per square meter) and indicates how well an area is lit.

Luminance L_v , represents the luminous flux incident per unit area per unit solid angle on a surface at a given point O [9]. It is measured in cd/m^2 (candelas per square meter) and relates directly to the perceived brightness of that surface.

According to the conversion method provided by [CIE](#), the photometric quantities can be derived by integrating the flux, irradiance or radiance weighted by the function $V(\lambda)$ over the whole visible region from $360nm$ to $830nm$:

$$\begin{aligned} F_v &= 683 \int_{360}^{830} F_\lambda \cdot V(\lambda) d\lambda \\ E_v &= 683 \int_{360}^{830} E_\lambda \cdot V(\lambda) d\lambda \\ L_v &= 683 \int_{360}^{830} L_\lambda \cdot V(\lambda) d\lambda \end{aligned} \tag{2.10}$$

The corresponding dataset of $V(\lambda)$ from $360nm$ to $830nm$ is provided by [CIE](#).

2.2 Spectral BRDF

The BRDF is first introduced by Fred Nicodemus in 1965 [10], which is rigorously defined as the ratio of reflected radiance in a given viewing direction to the incident irradiance from a specified light source direction, at a given surface point p . It is typically expressed in units of sr^{-1} . However, the BRDF alone does not capture the full complexity of how surfaces reflect light across different wavelengths. To gain a more comprehensive understanding of these interactions, we turn to the spectral BRDF which is an extension of the traditional BRDF [8]. It provides a wavelength-dependent function that characterizes how surfaces reflect light at specific incident and reflected angles at a given surface point p , across a narrow spectral bandwidth $\Delta\lambda$. Mathematically, it is expressed as:

$$f_r(p, \lambda, \theta_i, \varphi_i, \theta_r, \varphi_r) = \frac{dL(p, \lambda, \theta_r, \varphi_r)}{dE(p, \lambda, \theta_i, \varphi_i)}, \tag{2.11}$$

where:

- λ is the wavelength of light source;
- θ_i and φ_i are the zenith and azimuth angle of the unit incident direction $\vec{\omega}_i$:

$$\vec{\omega}_i = (x_i, y_i, z_i) = (\sin \theta_i \cos \varphi_i, \sin \theta_i \sin \varphi_i, \cos \theta_i)$$

- θ_r and φ_r are the zenith and azimuth angle of the unit reflected direction $\vec{\omega}_r$:

$$\vec{\omega}_r = (x_r, y_r, z_r) = (\sin \theta_r \cos \varphi_r, \sin \theta_r \sin \varphi_r, \cos \theta_r)$$

- $dL(p, \lambda, \theta_r, \varphi_r)$ is the spectral reflected radiance for waveband $\Delta\lambda$;

$$dL(p, \lambda, \theta_r, \varphi_r) = \int_{\Delta\lambda} dL_\lambda(p, \theta_r, \varphi_r) d\lambda$$

- $dE(p, \lambda, \theta_i, \varphi_i)$ is the spectral incident irradiance for waveband $\Delta\lambda$.

$$dE(p, \lambda, \theta_i, \varphi_i) = \int_{\Delta\lambda} dE_\lambda(p, \theta_i, \varphi_i) d\lambda$$

Replacing the term $dE(p, \lambda, \theta_i, \varphi_i)$ according to Equation (2.4), it can be defined in terms of incident radiance $L_i(p, \lambda, \theta_i, \varphi_i)$:

$$f_r(p, \lambda, \theta_i, \varphi_i, \theta_r, \varphi_r) = \frac{dL(p, \lambda, \theta_r, \varphi_r)}{\cos \theta_i L_i(p, \lambda, \theta_i, \varphi_i) d\theta_i d\varphi_i} \quad (2.12)$$

As both radiance and irradiance take into account the wavelength, the unit of spectral BRDF is still $[sr^{-1}]$.

Ideal diffuse reflection

One of the simplest and most widely used BRDF models is the Lambertian reflector, which is based on the assumption of a perfectly diffuse surface [8]. It has an angle-independent BRDF, proportional to their spectral albedo ρ_d for a given wavelength λ :

$$f_{r(Lambertian)}(p, \lambda, \theta_i, \varphi_i, \theta_r, \varphi_r) = \frac{\rho_d}{\pi} \quad (2.13)$$

Ideal specular reflection

In contrast to diffuse reflection, the perfect specular BRDF describes light incoming a given direction is reflected in a single direction following the law of reflection [11]:

$$f_{r(specular)}(p, \lambda, \theta_i, \varphi_i, \theta_r, \varphi_r) = F_r(\lambda, \theta_i) \frac{\delta(\vec{\omega}_r - \vec{\omega}_r^j)}{\cos \theta_r}, \quad (2.14)$$

where:

- $\vec{\omega}_r$ is the mirror direction which is symmetric to the incoming direction $\vec{\omega}_i$:

$$\vec{\omega}_r = 2(\vec{\omega}_i \cdot \vec{n})\vec{n} - \vec{\omega}_i = 2 \cos \theta_i \vec{n} - \vec{\omega}_i = (-\sin \theta_i \cos \varphi_i, -\sin \theta_i \sin \varphi_i, \cos \theta_i)$$

So we can derive its corresponding zenith and azimuth angle $(\theta_r, \varphi_r) = (\theta_i, \varphi_i + \pi)$.

- $\delta(\vec{\omega}_r - \vec{\omega}_i)$ is the delta dirac function:

$$\delta(\vec{\omega}_r - \vec{\omega}_i) = \begin{cases} \infty, & \text{if } \vec{\omega}_r = \vec{\omega}_i \\ 0, & \text{otherwise} \end{cases}$$

Notice that Its integral over all directions equals 1:

$$\int_{\Omega} \delta(\vec{\omega}_r - \vec{\omega}_i) d\vec{\omega}_r = 1$$

This ensures energy conservation in the reflection process.

- $F_r(\lambda, \theta_i)$ is the Fresnel reflectance of unpolarized light for a given wavelength λ following as:

$$F_r(\lambda, \theta_i) = \frac{1}{2} (r_{\parallel}(\lambda, \theta_i) + r_{\perp}(\lambda, \theta_i)) \quad (2.15)$$

$r_{\parallel}(\lambda, \theta_i)$ and $r_{\perp}(\lambda, \theta_i)$ are the conventional Fresnel coefficient [12] for a given wavelength λ , respectively for parallel and perpendicular polarized light. They are given as below while considering different interfaces:

- At the interface of two dielectric media:

$$r_{\parallel}(\lambda, \theta_i) = \left[\frac{\eta_t \cos \theta_i - \eta_i \cos \theta_t}{\eta_t \cos \theta_i + \eta_i \cos \theta_t} \right]^2$$

$$r_{\perp}(\lambda, \theta_i) = \left[\frac{\eta_i \cos \theta_i - \eta_t \cos \theta_t}{\eta_i \cos \theta_i + \eta_t \cos \theta_t} \right]^2$$

Where η_i, η_t are the refraction indices for the incident and transmitted media for a given wavelength λ . θ_t is the transmitted angle between the normal and transmitted direction:

$$\sin \theta_t = \frac{\eta_i \sin \theta_i}{\eta_t}$$

- At the boundary between a conductor and a dielectric medium:

$$r_{\parallel}(\lambda, \theta_i) = r_{\perp}(\lambda, \theta_i) \frac{\cos^2 \theta_i (a^2 + b^2) - 2a \cos \theta_i \sin^2 \theta_i + \sin^4 \theta_i}{\cos^2 \theta_i (a^2 + b^2) + 2a \cos \theta_i \sin^2 \theta_i + \sin^4 \theta_i}$$

$$r_{\perp}(\lambda, \theta_i) = \frac{a^2 + b^2 - 2a \cos \theta_i + \cos^2 \theta_i}{a^2 + b^2 + 2a \cos \theta_i + \cos^2 \theta_i}$$

Where:

$$\begin{aligned} 2a^2 &= \sqrt{(\eta^2 - k^2 - \sin^2 \theta_i)^2 + 4\eta^2 k^2} + (\eta^2 - k^2 - \sin^2 \theta_i) \\ 2b^2 &= \sqrt{(\eta^2 - k^2 - \sin^2 \theta_i)^2 + 4\eta^2 k^2} - (\eta^2 - k^2 - \sin^2 \theta_i) \\ a^2 + b^2 &= \sqrt{(\eta^2 - k^2 - \sin^2 \theta_i)^2 + 4\eta^2 k^2} \\ \eta + ik &= \frac{\eta_t + ik_t}{\eta_i + ik_i} \end{aligned}$$

Computing the exact Fresnel term can be highly time-consuming. To mitigate this, Schlick proposed an approximation in 1994 [13], which has become widely adopted in computer graphics [12, 14]. This approximation is following as below when considering different interfaces:

- At the interface between 2 dielectric mediums:

$$F_r(\lambda, \theta_i) = F_0(\lambda) + (1 - F_0(\lambda))(1 - \cos \theta_i)^5 \quad (2.16)$$

The term $F_0(\lambda)$ is the reflection coefficient for light incoming parallel to the normal:

$$F_0(\lambda) = \left(\frac{\eta_i - \eta_t}{\eta_i + \eta_t} \right)^2$$

- At the interface between air/vacuum and a conductor:

$$F(\lambda, \theta_i) = \frac{(\eta_t - 1)^2 + 4\eta_t(1 - \cos \theta_i)^5 + k_t^2}{(\eta_t + 1)^2 + k_t^2} \quad (2.17)$$

where η_t is the the index of refraction for the conductor and k_t is the absorption coefficient of the conductor.

Notice that when this approximation is used in a microfacet-based BRDF model for describing specular reflection, the angle θ_i corresponds to the local incident angle θ'_i . In geometry, it is the angle between the half-vector direction between half-vector direction $\vec{\omega}_h = \frac{\vec{\omega}_i + \vec{\omega}_r}{|\vec{\omega}_i + \vec{\omega}_r|}$ and the incident direction $\vec{\omega}_i$.

2.2.1 Properties

Similar to traditional BRDF, a physically plausible spectral BRDF also has the below properties:

- **Energy conservation**

A fundamental principle that must be adhered to by all BRDFs, including spectral BRDFs, is energy conservation. This ensures that the amount of light reflected by a surface does not exceed the amount of light incident upon it. Mathematically, this is often represented as:

$$\int_{\varphi_r=0}^{2\pi} \int_{\theta_r=0}^{\frac{\pi}{2}} f_r(p, \lambda, \theta_i, \varphi_i, \theta_r, \varphi_r) \cos(\theta_r) \sin(\theta_r) d\theta_r d\varphi_r \leq 1$$

- **Reciprocity**

The Helmholtz Reciprocity Rule states that the reflection characteristics should remain unchanged if the directions of light incidence and observation are swapped:

$$f_r(p, \lambda, \theta_i, \varphi_i, \theta_r, \varphi_r) = f_r(p, \lambda, \theta_r, \varphi_r, \theta_i, \varphi_i)$$

It ensures that light behaves consistently in all directions.

- **Non-negative**

The spectral BRDF is always non-negative, ensuring that the reflected radiance is physically meaningful:

$$f_r(p, \lambda, \theta_i, \varphi_i, \theta_r, \varphi_r) \geq 0$$

2.2.2 Isotropic and anisotropic

As spectral BRDF is an extension of traditional BRDF, it can be classified into two categories based on whether they exhibit rotational symmetry or not [11, 15]: isotropic and anisotropic. A material is considered isotropic when its reflectance remains constant for a fixed view and illumination, regardless of the rotation of the material around its normal. Mathematically, it can be expressed in term of the azimuth angle difference between incident direction and reflected direction:

$$f_r(p, \lambda, \theta_i, \varphi_i, \theta_r, \varphi_r) = f_r(p, \lambda, \theta_i, \theta_r, \varphi_r - \varphi_i)$$

In contrast, materials whose reflectance is not constant are considered anisotropic.

2.3 Photometric BRDF

Photometric BRDF has similar properties of spectral BRDF. The difference is that it is the BRDF over the whole visible region [8], which is the ratio of luminance L_v and illuminance E_v :

$$f_v(\theta_i, \phi_i, \theta_r, \phi_r) = \frac{dL_v(\theta_r, \phi_r)}{dE_v(\theta_i, \phi_i)} \quad (2.18)$$

2.4 Solar albedo

Another important optical property of road surface, solar albedo (also called solar reflectance) is introduced and discussed in this section.

2.4.1 Types of albedo

Solar albedo of a given surface is defined as the ratio of upward and downward radiation flux [16,17]. This ratio can vary between 0 and 1, where 0 indicates no reflection and 1 signifies complete reflection. Surfaces with higher albedo values reflect more sunlight, leading to cooler temperatures, while those with lower values absorb more radiation, resulting in higher temperatures. As such, it becomes an important factor affecting the temperature of a sunlit surface and that of near-surface ambient air temperature.

There are three primary types of albedo [16] that are commonly discussed, each with distinct implications for environmental and climatic conditions.

1. Black sky albedo

When the surface is illuminated with ideal directional radiation, the surface albedo is called black-sky albedo or directional-hemispherical reflectance:

$$\alpha_{black-sky}(\lambda, \theta_i, \varphi_i) = \frac{\int_0^{\pi/2} \int_0^{2\pi} L_\lambda(\theta_r, \varphi_r) d\theta_i d\varphi_i}{E_\lambda(\theta_i, \varphi_i)} \quad (2.19)$$

Where L_λ is the reflected radiance in the direction $\vec{\omega}_r$, and E_λ is the incident irradiance from the direction $\vec{\omega}_i$.

2. White sky albedo

When the surface is illuminated with ideal diffuse radiation, the surface albedo is called white-sky albedo or bi-hemispherical reflectance:

$$\alpha_{white-sky}(\lambda) = \frac{\int_0^{\pi/2} \int_0^{2\pi} L_\lambda(\theta_r, \varphi_r) d\theta_r d\varphi_r}{E_\lambda} \quad (2.20)$$

Different from the term E_λ in black-sky albedo, here it represents the incident irradiance from all directions into the hemisphere.

3. Blue sky albedo

In fact, the solar albedo we measured is usually under natural daylight illumination, including both directional and diffuse radiation. In this case, the surface albedo is called as blue-sky albedo, which can be approximately expressed as a linear combination of black-sky and white-sky albedo:

$$\alpha_{blue-sky}(\lambda, \theta_i, \varphi_i) \approx (1 - D(\tau, \lambda))\alpha_{black-sky}(\lambda, \theta_i, \varphi_i) + D(\tau, \lambda)\alpha_{white-sky}(\lambda) \quad (2.21)$$

Where $D(\tau, \lambda)$ gives the fraction of the diffuse radiation, varying with the aerosol optical wavelength τ and wavelength λ .

For a given waveband, its corresponding surface albedo can be estimated using the following equation:

$$\alpha(\theta_i, \varphi_i) = \frac{\int_{\lambda_1}^{\lambda_2} E_\lambda(\theta_i, \varphi_i) \alpha_\lambda(\theta_i, \varphi_i) d\lambda}{\int_{\lambda_1}^{\lambda_2} E_\lambda(\theta_i, \varphi_i) d\lambda} \quad (2.22)$$

2.4.2 The link between BRDF and solar albedo

According to the definition of BRDF, black-sky albedo and white sky albedo, we can find the link between them. The black-sky albedo can be derived by integrating BRDF over the viewing hemisphere:

$$\alpha_{black-sky}(\lambda, \theta_i, \varphi_i) = \int_{\varphi_r=0}^{2\pi} \int_{\theta_r=0}^{\frac{\pi}{2}} f_r(\lambda, \theta_i, \varphi_i, \theta_r, \varphi_r) \cos \theta_r \sin \theta_r d\theta_r d\varphi_r \quad (2.23)$$

Similarly, the white-sky albedo can be derived by integrating BRDF over the viewing hemisphere and incident hemisphere:

$$\alpha_{white-sky}(\lambda) = \frac{1}{\pi} \int_{\varphi_i=0}^{2\pi} \int_{\theta_i=0}^{\frac{\pi}{2}} \int_{\varphi_r=0}^{2\pi} \int_{\theta_r=0}^{\frac{\pi}{2}} f_r(\lambda, \theta_i, \varphi_i, \theta_r, \varphi_r) \cos \theta_i \sin \theta_i \cos \theta_r \sin \theta_r d\theta_i d\varphi_i d\theta_r d\varphi_r \quad (2.24)$$

For ideal diffuse reflection, we can conclude that the black-sky albedo and the white-sky albedo are equivalent to the albedo ρ used in Equation 2.13 by computing these two equations.

Chapter 3

BRDF models used in road surface

Reflectance models are typically introduced in order to achieve low-parameter representation of the BRDF measurements acquired from road surfaces [6]. Many road surfaces exhibit non-diffuse characteristics, simplified Lambertian assumptions are insufficient for accurate optical predictions. This is especially true for surfaces that include specular peaks due to polishing or for materials that have retro-reflective properties, such as in tunnel markings or retro-reflective coatings [18]. To address these complexities, this chapter explores a range of reflectance models utilized for characterizing the BRDF of various road materials, such as concrete, sand, aggregates.

3.1 Microfacet-based BRDF models

This section introduces two widely used reflectance models used in road surface: Oren-Nayar (ON) BRDF for describing diffuse reflection and Torrance Sparrow (TS) / Cook-Torrance (CT) BRDF for describing specular reflection. Both are based on microfacet theory which represents the surface of a collection of small surfaces. In graphics community, microfacet theory was used to derive physically based BRDF [19], and typically accounts for complex geometric and radiometric phenomena:

- shadowing, where the facet is only partially illuminated because the adjacent facet casts a shadow on it, as seen in Fig 3.1(a);

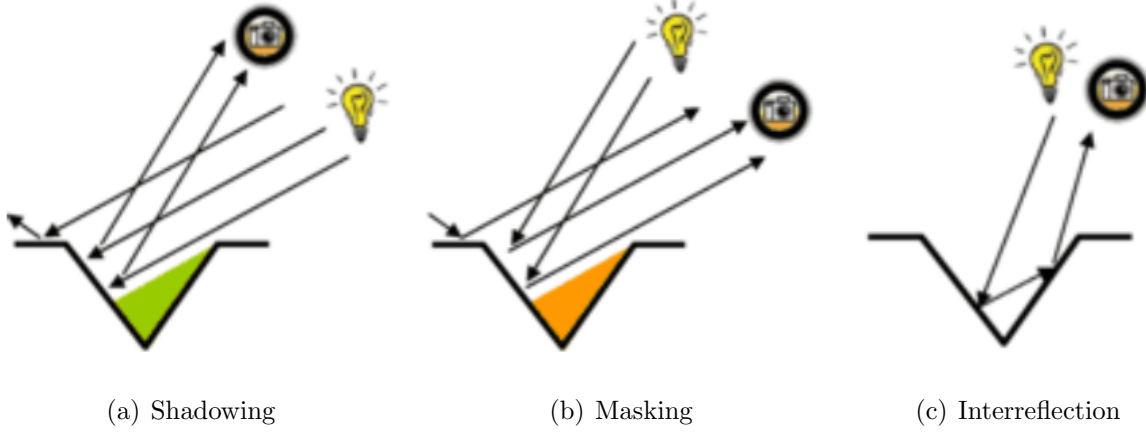


Figure 3.1: Physical phenomena in microfacets

- masking, where the facet is only partially visible to the camera because its adjacent facet occludes it, as seen in Fig 3.1(b).

Their impacts are described using shadowing function and masking function, respectively. A meaningful microfacet model is described by a distribution of normals, which models how the microfacets are statistically oriented, and a microfacet profile, which models how the microfacets are organized on the microfacet. Mathematically, the general microfacet-based BRDF expression is following as:

$$f_r(\lambda, \theta_i, \varphi_i, \theta_r, \varphi_r) = \frac{1}{\cos(\theta_r) \cos(\theta_i)} \int_0^{\pi/2} \int_0^{2\pi} f_{r(M)}(\lambda, \theta_i, \varphi_i, \theta_r, \varphi_r, \theta_m, \varphi_m) \times (\cos \theta'_r)(\cos \theta'_i) G(\theta_i, \varphi_i, \theta_r, \varphi_r, \theta_m, \varphi_m) D(\theta_m, \varphi_m) d\theta_m d\varphi_m, \quad (3.1)$$

where:

- θ_i, φ_i are the zenith and azimuth angles of the unit incident direction $\vec{\omega}_i$,
- θ_r, φ_r are the zenith and azimuth angles of the unit reflected direction $\vec{\omega}_r$,
- θ_m, φ_m are the zenith and azimuth angles of the unit normal of the microfacet $\vec{\omega}_m$,
- θ'_i is the angle between the incident direction $\vec{\omega}_i$ and the normal of the microfacet $\vec{\omega}_m$,
- θ'_r is the angle between the reflected direction $\vec{\omega}_r$ and the normal of the microfacet $\vec{\omega}_m$,
- $f_{r(M)}(\lambda, \theta_i, \varphi_i, \theta_r, \varphi_r, \theta_m, \varphi_m)$ is the BRDF of each microfacet,

- $D(\theta_m, \varphi_m)$ represents the distribution of the normals of the microfacets;
- $G(\theta_i, \varphi_i, \theta_r, \varphi_r, \theta_m, \varphi_m)$ is geometric attenuation function, combining masking G_1 and shadowing G_2 function. It gives the fraction of microfacets with normal $\vec{\omega}_m$ that are visible along the reflected direction $\vec{\omega}_r$, depending on the microfacet profile (e.g. V-cavity microfacet profile and smith microfacet profile) and the distribution of the microfacet's normal [19]. The masking G_1 and shadowing G_2 function are formalized by the following equations:

$$\begin{aligned}\cos \theta_r &= \int_0^{\pi/2} \int_0^{2\pi} G_1(\theta_r, \varphi_r, \theta_m, \varphi_m)(\cos \theta'_r) D(\theta_m, \varphi_m) d\theta_m d\varphi_m \\ \cos \theta_i &= \int_0^{\pi/2} \int_0^{2\pi} G_2(\theta_i, \varphi_i, \theta_m, \varphi_m)(\cos \theta'_i) D(\theta_m, \varphi_m) d\theta_m d\varphi_m\end{aligned}\tag{3.2}$$

3.1.1 Oren-Nayar BRDF

The Oren-Nayar BRDF is widely used for modelling diffuse reflections from rough surfaces, as it provides a more realistic representation of light behavior compared to simpler Lambertian model [6, 20]. This model was first proposed in 1994 [20] by Oren and Nayar, based on microfacet theory adapting V-cavity microfacet profile. More precisely, the surface is assumed as a collection of long, symmetric v-shaped cavities with equal length, each containing two opposing planar facets. This implies that each V-cavity has the two symmetric normals $\vec{\omega}_m$ and $\vec{\omega}'_m$, leading to the following distribution of normals of each microfacet $D(\theta, \varphi)$:

$$D(\theta, \varphi) = \frac{1}{2} \frac{\delta(\vec{\omega} - \vec{\omega}_m)}{\cos \theta_m} + \frac{1}{2} \frac{\delta(\vec{\omega} - \vec{\omega}'_m)}{\cos \theta'_m}$$

Where θ_m, θ'_m are zenith angles of the normals of the microfacet $\vec{\omega}_m, \vec{\omega}'_m$.

The masking or shadowing term can be derived according to Equation(3.2) considering if there is no or one backfacing normal direction:

$$\begin{aligned}G_1(\theta_r, \varphi_r, \theta_m, \varphi_m) &= \min \left(1, 2 \frac{(\cos \theta_m)(\cos \theta_r)}{(\cos \theta'_r)} \right) \\ G_2(\theta_i, \varphi_i, \theta_m, \varphi_m) &= \min \left(1, 2 \frac{(\cos \theta_m)(\cos \theta_m)}{(\cos \theta'_i)} \right)\end{aligned}$$

Considering both masking and shadowing, the term $G(\theta_i, \varphi_i, \theta_r, \varphi_r, \theta_m, \varphi_m)$ can be derived as:

$$G(\theta_i, \varphi_i, \theta_r, \varphi_r, \theta_m, \varphi_m) = \min \left(1, 2 \frac{(\cos \theta_m)(\cos \theta_r)}{(\cos \theta'_r)}, 2 \frac{(\cos \theta_m)(\cos \theta_m)}{(\cos \theta'_i)} \right) \quad (3.3)$$

The distribution of the normals of all microfacets is described using a spherical gaussian distribution with a mean value of zero and a standard deviation α , which serves as a roughness parameter:

$$D_{gaussian}(\theta_m) = ce^{-\frac{\theta_m^2}{2\alpha^2}}, \quad (3.4)$$

where the normalization constant c is:

$$c = \frac{1}{\int_{\varphi_m=0}^{2\pi} \int_{\theta_m}^{\frac{\pi}{2}} e^{-\frac{\theta_m^2}{2\alpha^2}} \sin \theta_m d\theta_m d\varphi_m}$$

Besides, the facets are assumed to exhibit diffuse reflection, implying the BRDF of each microfacet $f_{r(M)}$ is defined as shown in Equation (2.13). By substituting $f_{r(M)}$ from Equation(2.13) , G from Equation(3.3) and D from Equation(3.4) into Equation(3.1), the reflectance model is obtained. However, the resulting integral can not be easily evaluated. Therefore, Oren and Nayar provided an approximation by using a identified basis function and conducting a large amounts of numerical simulations to evaluate this integral. The approximated expression of directly reflected part is following as:

$$f_r^{dir}(\lambda, \theta_i, \theta_r, \varphi) = \frac{\rho_d}{\pi} [C_1(\alpha) + C_2(\theta_1, \theta_2, \varphi, \alpha) \cos(\varphi) \tan(\theta_2) + C_3(\theta_1, \theta_2, \alpha) (1 - |\cos(\varphi)|) \tan \left(\frac{\theta_1 + \theta_2}{2} \right)]$$

where:

- ρ_d is the albedo of each facet;
- $\varphi = |\varphi_i - \varphi_r|$ is the relative azimuth angle;
- $\theta_1 = \max(\theta_i, \theta_r)$ is the maximum zenith angle between θ_i and θ_r ;
- $\theta_2 = \min(\theta_i, \theta_r)$ is the minimum zenith angles between θ_i and θ_r ;
- α (in radians) is a parameter for the surface roughness, which is gaussian standard deviation in angles of the microfacets normal

- C_1, C_2, C_3 are constant:

$$\begin{aligned}
C_1(\alpha) &= 1 - 0.5 \frac{\alpha^2}{\alpha^2 + 0.33} \\
C_2(\theta_1, \theta_2, \varphi, \alpha) &= \begin{cases} 0.45 \frac{\alpha^2}{\alpha^2 + 0.09} \sin(\theta_1), & \text{if } \cos(\varphi) \geq 0 \\ 0.45 \frac{\alpha^2}{\alpha^2 + 0.09} \left(\sin(\theta_1) - \left(\frac{2\theta_2}{\pi} \right)^3 \right), & \text{otherwise} \end{cases} \\
C_3(\theta_1, \theta_2, \alpha) &= 0.125 \left(\frac{\alpha^2}{\alpha^2 + 0.09} \right) \left(\frac{4\theta_1\theta_2}{\pi^2} \right)^2
\end{aligned}$$

In a V-cavity microfacet, apart from the shadowing and masking effects described in microfacet theory, light rays may also bounce between adjacent facets, as seen in Fig 3.1(c). This phenomenon is referred to as inter-reflections. In the case of Lambertian surfaces, the energy in an incident light diminishes rapidly with each inter-reflection bounce [20]. Accordingly, Oren and Nayar consider only two bounces inter-reflections and neglect the subsequent bounces. Similar to direct illumination component, the multiple inter-reflections part is approximated as:

$$f_r^{ms}(\lambda, \theta_i, \theta_r, \varphi) = 0.17 \frac{\rho_d^2}{\pi} \frac{\alpha^2}{\alpha^2 + 0.13} \left(1 - \frac{4\theta_2^2}{\pi^2} \cos(\varphi) \right)$$

Combing the directly reflected part and the multiple inter-reflections part, the complete expression of the ON BRDF is:

$$f_{r(ON)}(\lambda, \theta_i, \theta_r, \varphi) = f_r^{dir}(\lambda, \theta_i, \theta_r, \varphi) + f_r^{ms}(\lambda, \theta_i, \theta_r, \varphi) \quad (3.5)$$

Notice that this model reduces to Lambertian BRDF when the roughness $\alpha = 0$.

This model has been applied to road materials, such as plaster and white sand in [20], where it provides a good fit with experimental measurements, with the fitting parameters $\rho_d = 0.9, \alpha = 30^\circ$ for the former and $\rho_d = 0.8, \alpha = 35^\circ$ for the latter.

3.1.2 Torrance-Sparrow / Cook Torrance BRDF

The specular reflection model of rough surfaces first introduced by Torrance and Sparrow in 1967 has gained widespread attention [6, 20–23]. This model is also based on microfacet theory, where

each facet is assumed to exhibit specular reflection, corresponding to Equation (2.14). Consequently, the BRDF of each microfacet $f_{r(M)}$ presented in Equation(3.1) can be derived as:

$$\begin{aligned} f_{r(M)}(\lambda, \theta_i, \varphi_i, \theta_r, \varphi_r, \theta_m, \varphi_m) &= \left| \frac{\partial \vec{\omega}_h}{\partial \vec{\omega}_i} \right| \frac{F_r(\lambda, \theta'_i) \delta(\vec{\omega}_m - \vec{\omega}_h)}{|\cos \theta'_i|} \\ &= \frac{F_r(\lambda, \theta'_i) \delta(\vec{\omega}_m - \vec{\omega}_h)}{4 |\cos \theta'_i|^2}, \end{aligned}$$

where $\vec{\omega}_h$ is unit halfway vector, and defined as:

$$\begin{aligned} \vec{\omega}_h &= \frac{\vec{\omega}_i + \vec{\omega}_r}{|\vec{\omega}_i + \vec{\omega}_r|} = (x_h, y_h, z_h) \\ x_h &= \frac{x_i + x_r}{\sqrt{(x_i + x_r)^2 + (y_i + y_r)^2 + (z_i + z_r)^2}} \\ y_h &= \frac{y_i + y_r}{\sqrt{(x_i + x_r)^2 + (y_i + y_r)^2 + (z_i + z_r)^2}} \\ z_h &= \frac{z_i + z_r}{\sqrt{(x_i + x_r)^2 + (y_i + y_r)^2 + (z_i + z_r)^2}} \end{aligned} \tag{3.6}$$

The term $\left| \frac{\partial \vec{\omega}_h}{\partial \vec{\omega}_i} \right|$ is the jacobian of the reflection transformation [19, 24]:

$$\left| \frac{\partial \vec{\omega}_h}{\partial \vec{\omega}_i} \right| = \frac{1}{4 |\vec{\omega}_i \cdot \vec{\omega}_h|} = \frac{1}{4 |\cos \theta'_i|}$$

Putting this $f_{r(M)}$ into Equation(3.1), we can replace the integral by the integrand evaluated at $\vec{\omega}_m = \vec{\omega}_h$ according to the delta dirac function $\delta(\vec{\omega}_m - \vec{\omega}_h)$. Thanks to $\vec{\omega}_r \cdot \vec{\omega}_h = \vec{\omega}_i \cdot \vec{\omega}_h$, we arrive the final expression of TS BRDF:

$$f_{r(TS)}(\theta_i, \varphi_i, \theta_r, \varphi_r) = \frac{F_r(\lambda, \theta'_i) G(\theta_i, \varphi_i, \theta_r, \varphi_r, \theta_h, \varphi_h) D(\theta_h)}{4 \cos \theta_i \cos \theta_r} \tag{3.7}$$

Notice that inter-reflections are not taken into account in this model.

It is known that the geometric attention function G given in Equation (3.1) is dependent of microfacet profile. Two widely used microfacet profiles in this model are introduced: V-cavity and smith.

- **V-cavity microfacet profile**

The original formulation of Torrance-Sparrow (TS) model adapted the former profile [21, 25]. Similar to the microfacet profile used in ON model, it represents the surface as a collection of symmetric V-cavity microfacet, leading to the same G function as Equation (3.3). The

probability distribution of the microfacets normals $D(\theta_h)$ is often described by zero-mean Gaussian distribution function [6, 21], as given in Equation (3.4). Later, Cook and Torrance introduced this reflectance model to computer graphics, replacing the Gaussian function with the Beckmann distribution function [19, 26], which is derived from it:

$$D_{Beckmann}(\theta_h) = \frac{\chi^+(\cos \theta_h)}{\pi \alpha^2 \cos^4(\theta_h)} \exp\left(-\frac{\tan^2(\theta_h)}{\alpha^2}\right) \quad (3.8)$$

Where the step function $\chi^+(\cos \theta_h)$ is the binary discard of backfacing microfacet:

$$\chi^+(\cos \theta_h) = \begin{cases} 1, & \text{if } \cos \theta_h > 0 \\ 0, & \text{else} \end{cases} \quad (3.9)$$

Unlike the Gaussian model, the Beckmann distribution gives the absolute magnitude of reflectance without introducing arbitrary constants. However, it is more computationally expensive.

- **Smith microfacet profile**

Building on Cook-Torrance (CT) reflectance model, the Smith microfacet profile was introduced into it later [19]. This profile represents more realistic surface but is more complicated, as it assumes that the microfacets are not auto-correlated. More precisely, it represents a random set of microfacets instead of a continuous surface, where the heights and normals of the microfacets are independent random variables [19]. A commonly used form of smith joint height-correlated masking-shadowing function is given as:

$$G(\theta_i, \varphi, \theta_r, \phi_r, \theta_h, \varphi_h) = \frac{\chi^+(\cos \theta'_r) \chi^+(\cos \theta'_i)}{1 + \Lambda(\theta_r) + \Lambda(\theta_i)}, \quad (3.10)$$

where $\Lambda(\theta_r)$ and $\Lambda(\theta_i)$ are auxiliary functions, which arise naturally when the derivation of masking and shadowing is conducted in the slope domain. This term depends on the chosen distribution function D . And the local incident angle θ'_i and the local reflected angle θ'_r can be computed via the following equations:

$$\begin{aligned} \cos \theta'_i &= \vec{\omega}_i \cdot \vec{\omega}_h \\ \cos \theta'_r &= \vec{\omega}_r \cdot \vec{\omega}_h \end{aligned} \quad (3.11)$$

To describe the statistical orientation of smith microfacets, two common microfacet distributions are used in Cook-Torrance model: **Beckmann distribution** and **GGX (also known as Trowbridge-Reitz)** distribution. The former one is applicable for a wide of surface conditions from smooth to very rough, and its mathematical expression is given in Equation (3.8). It produces a more sharply peaked distribution near the surface normal and falls off more rapidly for grazing angles. Its associated $\Lambda(\theta_r)$ and $\Lambda(\theta_i)$ are:

$$\begin{aligned}\Lambda(\theta_r) &= \frac{\operatorname{erf}(a)-1}{2} + \frac{1}{2a\sqrt{\pi}} \exp(-a^2) \\ \Lambda(\theta_i) &= \frac{\operatorname{erf}(a')-1}{2} + \frac{1}{2a'\sqrt{\pi}} \exp(-a'^2)\end{aligned}\tag{3.12}$$

Where $a = \frac{1}{\alpha \tan \theta_r}$ and $a' = \frac{1}{\alpha \tan \theta_i}$. A given approximated $\Lambda(\theta_r)$ explained in [19, 24] follows as:

$$\Lambda(\theta_r) \approx \begin{cases} \frac{1-1.259a+0.396a^2}{3.535a+2.181a^2}, & \text{if } a < 1.6 \\ 0, & \text{otherwise} \end{cases}\tag{3.13}$$

The approximation of $\Lambda(\theta_r)$ can be obtained by replacing a with a' .

The latter is designed to have a heavier tail, implying that it decays more slowly at grazing angles. Its mathematical expression is given as:

$$D_{GGX}(\theta_h) = \frac{\chi^+(\cos \theta_h)}{\pi \alpha^2 \cos^4(\theta_h) \left(1 + \frac{\tan^2(\theta_h)}{\alpha^2}\right)^2}\tag{3.14}$$

Its corresponding $\Lambda(\theta_r)$ and $\Lambda(\theta_i)$ follows as:

$$\begin{aligned}\Lambda(\theta_r) &= \frac{-1+\sqrt{1+\frac{1}{a^2}}}{2} \\ \Lambda(\theta_i) &= \frac{-1+\sqrt{1+\frac{1}{a'^2}}}{2}\end{aligned}\tag{3.15}$$

Real-world road surface requires an accurate description of surface reflections which cannot be regarded in the traditional ON model. To address this limitation, this model is extended by a specular part, described by TS reflectance model using same v-cavity microfacet profile and the spherical gaussian distribution [6, 20, 21]. Linearly combining TS BRDF $f_{r(CT)}$ and ON BRDF $f_{r(ON)}$ using weighting factors, the new blended BRDF can be expressed as:

$$f_{r(ON-TS)}(\lambda, \theta_i, \varphi_i, \theta_r, \varphi_r) = k_d f_{r(ON)}(\lambda, \theta_i, \varphi_i, \theta_r, \varphi_r) + k_s f_{r(TS)}(\lambda, \theta_i, \varphi_i, \theta_r, \varphi_r)\tag{3.16}$$

Where the weighting factors k_d and k_s are respectively for diffuse component and the specular component. This mixed model is employed for fitting the measured BRDF of the mixed-material road surfaces [6, 21], achieving a good agreement with measurements.

Another blended BRDF by mixing TS model and Lambertian model (Equation (2.13)) is employed for modelling the road material, such as blue or red concrete [21], exhibiting a good fit with the measured BRDF:

$$f_{r(Lambertian-TS)}(\lambda, \theta_i, \varphi_i, \theta_r, \varphi_r) = k_d f_{r(Lambertian)}(\lambda, \theta_i, \varphi_i, \theta_r, \varphi_r) + k_s f_{r(TS)}(\lambda, \theta_i, \varphi_i, \theta_r, \varphi_r) \quad (3.17)$$

3.2 Ashikhmin-Shirley BRDF

This model is physically based model, and controlled by intuitive parameters [27]:

$$f_{r(AS)}(\lambda, \theta_i, \varphi_i, \theta_r, \varphi_r) = k_d f_{r(AS)}^d(\lambda, \theta_i, \varphi_i, \theta_r, \varphi_r) + k_s f_{r(AS)}^s(\lambda, \theta_i, \varphi_i, \theta_r, \varphi_r) \quad (3.18)$$

Where:

- Diffuse component f_r^d :

$$f_{r(AS)}^d(\lambda, \theta_i, \varphi_i, \theta_r, \varphi_r) = \frac{28\rho_d(1 - k_s F_0)}{23\pi} \left(1 - \left(1 - \frac{\cos \theta_i}{2} \right)^5 \right) \left(1 - \left(1 - \frac{\cos \theta_r}{2} \right)^5 \right)$$

- Specular component f_r^s :

$$f_{r(AS)}^s(\lambda, \theta_i, \varphi_i, \theta_r, \varphi_r) = \frac{\sqrt{(n_u + 1)(n_v + 1)} (\cos \theta_h)^{n_u \cos^2 \varphi_h + n_v \sin^2 \varphi_h}}{8\pi \max(\cos \theta_i, \cos \theta_r) \cos \theta'_i} F(\lambda, \theta'_i)$$

- k_d, k_s are weighting factors respectively for diffuse and specular reflection,
- ρ_d is the diffuse reflectance of substrate under the specular coating,
- F_0 is the specular reflectance at normal incidence:

$$F_0(\lambda) = \left(\frac{\eta_i - \eta_t}{\eta_i + \eta_t} \right)^2$$

- θ_h is the zenith angle of unit half-vector direction $\vec{\omega}_h$, its corresponding cos is given as below:

$$\cos \theta_h = z_h$$

z_h is given in Equation (3.6).

- φ_h is the azimuth angles of the half-vector direction $\vec{\omega}_h$. Its corresponding cos and sin can be computed as:

$$\begin{aligned}\cos \varphi_h &= \frac{x_h}{\sqrt{1-z_h^2}} \\ \sin \varphi_h &= \frac{y_h}{\sqrt{1-z_h^2}}\end{aligned}$$

x_h, y_h, z_h are given in Equation (3.6).

- θ'_r is the local reflected angle (see in Equation (3.11)), which is the angle between the incident direction $\vec{\omega}_r$ and the half-vector $\vec{\omega}_h$,
- n_u, n_v are two phong-like exponents that control the shape of the specular lobe,
- $F(\lambda, \theta'_i)$ is the Fresnel term from Schlick's approximation, as given in Equation (2.16).

This model:

- Physically based
- No reference result to verify the codes

3.3 Simonot BRDF

This model describe the surfaces as a distribution of microfacet where each facet consists of a flat interface on a Lambertian background [28].

$$f_{r(Simonot)}(\lambda, \theta_i, \varphi_i, \theta_r, \varphi_r) = f_{r(Simonot)}^d(\lambda, \theta_i, \varphi_i, \theta_r, \varphi_r) + f_{r(Simonot)}^s(\lambda, \theta_i, \varphi_i, \theta_r, \varphi_r) \quad (3.19)$$

Where:

- Diffuse component f_r^d :

$$f_{r(Simonot)}^d(\lambda, \theta_i, \varphi_i, \theta_r, \varphi_r) = \frac{\rho_d}{\pi(1 - \rho_d r_{10})} (\eta_0/\eta_1)^2 (1 - R_{01}(\theta_i))(1 - R_{01}(\theta_r))$$

- Specular component f_r^s :

$$f_{r(Simonot)}^s(\lambda, \theta_i, \varphi_i, \theta_r, \varphi_r) = R_{01}(\theta_i) \frac{\delta(\theta_r - \theta_i) \delta(\varphi_i + \pi - \varphi_r)}{\cos \theta_i \sin \theta_i}$$

- ρ_d is the intrinsic background reflectance factor for a given wavelength λ ,

- η_0, η_1 are the refraction indices of the media 0 and 1 for a given wavelength λ , respectively,
- R_{01} is the reflectance of the interface between media 0 and 1:

$$R_{01}(\theta_0) = \frac{1}{2} \left[\frac{\tan^2(\theta_0 - \theta_1)}{\tan^2(\theta_0 + \theta_1)} + \frac{\sin^2(\theta_0 - \theta_1)}{\sin^2(\theta_0 + \theta_1)} \right]$$

$$- \text{ when } \theta_0 = \theta_i, \sin \theta_1 = \frac{\eta_0 \sin \theta_i}{\eta_1}$$

$$- \text{ when } \theta_0 = \theta_r, \sin \theta_1 = \frac{\eta_0 \sin \theta_r}{\eta_1}$$

- r_{10} is the reflectance from medium 1:

$$1 - r_{10} = (\eta_0/\eta_1)^2(1 - r_{01})$$

- r_{01} is the reflectance of a flat interface illuminated by Lambertian light from medium 0 is derived from Fresnel's reflectance:

$$r_{01} = \int_0^{\pi/2} R_{01}(\theta_0) \sin 2\theta_0 \theta_0$$

- δ is a dirac delta function:

$$\delta(\theta_r - \theta_i) = \begin{cases} \infty, & \text{if } \theta_r = \theta_i \\ 0, & \text{otherwise} \end{cases}$$

This model:

- Not sure Physically based
- reference result to verify the codes

3.4 Kelemen-Kalos BRDF

This microfacet-based model is physically based model [29]:

$$f_{r(KK)}(\lambda, \theta_i, \varphi_i, \theta_r, \varphi_r) = f_{r(KK)}^{matt}(\lambda, \theta_i, \varphi_i, \theta_r, \varphi_r) + f_{r(KK)}^s(\lambda, \theta_i, \varphi_i, \theta_r, \varphi_r) \quad (3.20)$$

Where:

- Matt component f_r^{matt} accounts for multiple reflections and re-emissions of previously absorbed photons:

$$f_{r(KK)}^{matt}(\lambda, \theta_i, \varphi_i, \theta_r, \varphi_r) = \rho_d \frac{(1 - \rho_s(\theta_i))(1 - \rho_s(\theta_r))}{\pi(1 - \bar{\rho}_s)}$$

- Specular component f_r^s represents single reflections

$$f_{r(KK)}^s(\lambda, \theta_i, \varphi_i, \theta_r, \varphi_r) = \frac{D(\theta_h)F_r(\lambda, \theta'_i)}{4 \cos^2 \theta'_i}$$

- ρ_d is a wavelength dependent diffuse albedo,
- $\rho_s(\theta_i)$ and $\rho_s(\theta_r)$ are the albedos of the specular component:

$$\begin{aligned} \rho_s(\theta_i) &= \int_0^{\pi/2} \int_0^{2\pi} f_{r(KK)}^s(\lambda, \theta_i, \varphi_i, \theta_r, \varphi_r) \cos \theta_r \sin \theta_r d\theta_r d\varphi_r \\ \rho_s(\theta_r) &= \int_0^{\pi/2} \int_0^{2\pi} f_{r(KK)}^s(\lambda, \theta_i, \varphi_i, \theta_i, \varphi_r) \cos \theta_i \sin \theta_i d\theta_i d\varphi_i \end{aligned}$$

- $\bar{\rho}_s$ is the average albedo of specular component:

$$\bar{\rho}_s = \frac{1}{\pi} \int_0^{\pi/2} \int_0^{2\pi} \rho_s(\theta_r) \cos \theta_r \sin \theta_r d\theta_r d\varphi_r$$

- The local including angle θ'_i is the angle between the incident direction $\vec{\omega}_i$ and the half-vector direction $\vec{\omega}_h$. Its corresponding cos and sin can be computed using Equation (3.11).
- $F_r(\lambda, \theta'_i)$ is the Fresnel term as described in Section 2.2 of Chapter 2.
- $D(\theta_h)$ is microfacet orientation probability density function. This model utilized 3 different distribution functions: Beckmann, Ward and Phong. The Beckmann distribution function is given as:

$$D_{Beckmann}(\theta_h) = \frac{1}{\alpha^2 \cos^4 \theta_h} e^{-\left(\frac{\tan^2 \theta_h}{\alpha^2}\right)} \quad (3.21)$$

The Ward distribution function is following as:

$$D_{Ward}(\theta_h) = \frac{1}{\pi \alpha^2 \cos^3 \theta_h} e^{-\left(\frac{\tan^2 \theta_h}{\alpha^2}\right)} \quad (3.22)$$

The Phong distribution function is :

$$D_{Phong}(\theta_h) = \frac{m+1}{2\pi} \cos^m \theta_h \quad (3.23)$$

- α is the surface roughness
- m is the specular reflectivity.

This model:

- Physically based
- reference result to verify the codes

3.5 Burley-Disney BRDF

This model is microfacet based model, but may not physically based [30]:

$$f_{r(BD)}(\lambda, \theta_i, \varphi_i, \theta_r, \varphi_r) = f_{r(BD)}^d(\lambda, \theta_i, \varphi_i, \theta_r, \varphi_r) + f_{r(TS)}^s(\lambda, \theta_i, \varphi_i, \theta_r, \varphi_r) \quad (3.24)$$

- Diffuse component f_r^d :

$$f_{r(BD)}^d(\lambda, \theta_i, \varphi_i, \theta_r, \varphi_r) = \frac{\rho_d}{\pi} (1 + (F_D(\theta'_i) - 1)(1 - \cos \theta_i)^5) (1 + (F_D(\theta'_i) - 1)(1 - \cos \theta_r)^5)$$

- Specular component f_r^s is Torrance-Sparrow BRDF given in Equation (3.7). Notice that the author utilized 3 microfacet distribution functions: Berry, Trowbridge-Reitz (TG, also called GGX) and Generalized Trowbridge-Reitz (TGR):

$$\begin{aligned} D_{Berry}(\theta_h) &= c/(\alpha^2 \cos^2 \theta_h + \sin^2 \theta_h) \\ D_{TR}(\theta_h) &= c/(\alpha^2 \cos^2 \theta_h + \sin^2 \theta_h)^2 \\ D_{GTR}(\theta_h) &= c/(\alpha^2 \cos^2 \theta_h + \sin^2 \theta_h)^\gamma \end{aligned}$$

They use the G term derived for GGX by Walter [24] and the Fresnel term of Schlick approximation given in Equation (2.16).

- θ'_i is the angle between the incident direction $\vec{\omega}_i$ and the half-vector direction $\vec{\omega}_h$, which is given in Equation (3.11),
- ρ_d is the diffuse albedo,
- $F_D(\theta'_i)$ is:

$$F_D(\theta'_i) = 0.5 + 2\alpha_d \cos^2 \theta'_i$$

- α_d is the surface roughness,
- c is a scaling constant,
- α is roughness parameter from 0 to 1,
- γ is suggested to be between 1 and 2.

This model:

- Not physically based
- No reference result to verify the codes

3.6 Lafortune BRDF

A multifunctional empirical reflectance model introduced by Eric Lafortune and his collaborators in 1997 [31, 32], was used to fit measurements from realistic surface. This model is developed based on Phong model [32], decomposed in a sum of lobes, where each lobe represents a specific component of reflection (e.g., specular, diffuse, or retro-reflection):

$$f_{r(1-lobe)}(\theta_i, \varphi_i, \theta_r, \varphi_r) = \rho \max \left(C_x \vec{\omega}_{r_x} \vec{\omega}_{i_x} + C_y \vec{\omega}_{r_y} \vec{\omega}_{i_y} + C_z \vec{\omega}_{r_z} \vec{\omega}_{i_z} \right)^n, \quad (3.25)$$

where ρ and n are the albedo and the specular reflectivity. The terms C_x, C_y, C_z are diagonal coefficients which can be seen as weighting the terms of the dot product $\vec{\omega}_r \cdot \vec{\omega}_i$. It is worth noting that $C_x = C_y$ leading to isotropic directional-diffuse lobe, otherwise anisotropic. The term n represents the specular reflectivity. When $n = 0$ and $n \rightarrow \infty$, this model corresponds to lambertian model and specular model, respectively. To represent a complex realistic reflectance functions, Lafortune computes a sum of several primitive functions presented in the form of Equation (3.25) by absorbing the albedo ρ and the other parameters:

$$f_{r(Lafortune)}(\theta_i, \varphi_i, \theta_r, \varphi_r) = \max \left(\sum_i \rho_i \left[C_{x,i} \omega_{r_x} \omega_{i_x} + C_{y,i} \omega_{r_y} \omega_{i_y} + C_{z,i} \omega_{r_z} \omega_{i_z} \right]^{n_i}, 0 \right) \quad (3.26)$$

Where each primitive function i is defined by the parameters $C_{x,i}$ ($= C_{y,i}$), $C_{z,i}$ and n_i . This model allows us to fit the measured BRDF of road surface in different status (e.g. dry and wet [32] using the following fitting parameters), where the materials of roads are not specified:

- dry road: $\rho_d = 0.2, \rho_s = 0.3, C_x = -1, C_y = -1, C_z = 1, n = 5$
- wet road: $\rho_d = 0.2, \rho_s = 0.8, C_x = -1, C_y = -1, C_z = 1, n = 15$

Furthermore, its mathematical formulation renders the model computationally efficient and relatively simple, making it a promising choice for fitting the measured BRDF in this study.

3.7 Retro-phong BRDF

In [33], a new extended Phong model was introduced by Spieringhs et al. in 2023. The authors took into account the effect of retro-reflection for road markings. In essence, this model is a linear combination of Lambertian reflector and Phong reflector:

$$f_{r(Retro-Phong)}(\theta_i, \phi_i, \theta_r, \phi_r) = \frac{k_d}{\pi} + \frac{k_s(\theta_i)(n+2)}{2\pi} (\vec{\omega}_{is} \cdot \vec{\omega}_r)^n + \frac{k_r(\theta_i)(n+2)}{2\pi} (\vec{\omega}_i \cdot \vec{\omega}_r)^n \quad (3.27)$$

Where k_d , k_s and k_r are the parameters for diffuse component, specular component and retro-reflection component. And n represents the exponential parameter controlling the material's shininess, where larger values of n produce large specular highlights. The term $\vec{\omega}_{is}$ is the specular reflection unit vector in the direction of $\varphi_i + \pi$. To satisfy the principle of energy conservation, these three factors are subject to the following constraint:

$$k_d + k_s + k_r < 1$$

Besides, the parameter k_r can be expressed as a simple linear function of the incident angle θ_i :

$$k_r(\theta_i) = k_1(1 - \cos(\theta_i)) + k_2$$

And the parameter k_s can be represented as a simple exponential function:

$$k_s = k_3 e^{k_4(1 - \cos(\theta_i))}$$

This model has been employed for 3 road marking materials [33] containing glass beads, achieving a good fit with the measured results using the following fitting parameters:

- SWARCOLimboplast D480 withMegalux 0.6-1.5 KT14

$$k_d = 0.620, n = 24, k_1 = 0.158, k_2 = 0.0145, k_3 = 0.00133, k_4 = 5.47$$

- SWARCOLimboplast D480 with P21 3:1

$$k_d = 0.594, n = 24, k_1 = 0.0696, k_2 = 0.0733, k_3 = 5.58e - 05, k_4 = 8.74$$

- 3MStamark A650

$$k_d = 0.701, n = 68, k_1 = 0.184, k_2 = 0.153e - 12, k_3 = 0.00570, k_4 = 3.40$$

3.8 Hapke's SHOE BRDF model

A well-known semi-empirical BRDF model widely used for beach sand desert was developed by Hapke in the 1980s [34–36]. This model is based on radiative transfer theory and formally incorporated the Shadow Hiding Opposition Effect (SHOE), and typically expressed as:

$$f_{r(Hapke-SHOE)}(\theta_i, \varphi_i, \theta_r, \varphi_r) = \frac{\rho_{ss}}{4\pi \cos \theta_i + \cos \theta_r} \{ [1 + B(g)] p(g) + H(\theta_i)H(\theta_r) - 1 \}, \quad (3.28)$$

where:

- θ_i, φ_i are the incident zenith and azimuth angles.
- θ_r, φ_r are the emitted reflectance zenith and azimuth angles.
- ρ_{ss} is the single scattering albedo.
- g is the phase angle, which is the zenith angle difference between the incident direction and emitted reflectance direction.
- $B(g)$ is the opposition effect term specifically incorporates the SHOE:

$$B(g) = \frac{B_0}{1 + \frac{1}{h \tan(g/2)}}$$

- B_0 is the height of the backscatter peak;
- h is width of the backscatter peak;
- $p(g)$ is the scattering phase function, which quantifies the angular distribution of scattered light relative to the direction of the incoming light.

In general, the scattering behaviors are usually classified into 3 types:

- forward scattering
- backward scattering
- isotropic (light is scattered equally in all direction, indicating $p(\theta) = 1$)

In the Henyey-Greenstein (HG) phase function expressed in the following equation, these behaviors are described by a single parameter ζ (also called asymmetry factor), corresponding to $\zeta > 0$, $\zeta < 0$ and $\zeta = 0$ respectively.

$$p(g) = p_{HG}(g) = \frac{1 - \zeta^2}{(1 + \zeta \cos(g) + \zeta^2)^{3/2}}$$

- $H(\theta)$ is the angular dependent function:

$$H(\theta) = \frac{1 + 2 \cos \theta}{1 + 2 \cos \theta \sqrt{1 - \rho_{ss}}}$$

To fit the measured BRDF, this model is required to find the 4 unknown parameters which are the SHOE backscatter parameters B_0 and h , and the asymmetry factor ζ and the single scattering albedo ρ_{ss} . This complicated parameterization may lead to high computation complexity and so expensive time cost. To address this, some researchers made minor modification by substituting the product $[1 + B(g)]p(g)$ of Hapke's SHOE model with a series expansion of Legendre Polynomials $\left\{1 + \sum_{n=1}^N a_n P_n\right\}$. As such, the final expression of this model becomes:

$$f_{r(Hapke-SHOE)}(\theta_i, \varphi_i, \theta_r, \varphi_r) = \frac{\rho_{ss}}{4\pi} \frac{1}{\cos \theta_i + \cos \theta_r} \left\{ \sum_{n=1}^N a_n P_n + H(\theta_i)H(\theta_r) \right\} \quad (3.29)$$

Where P_n represents the Legendre Polynomials of order n starting from 1, and the coefficients a_n are the parameters fitted to the Measurements data. This modified model is also called as Hapke SPF BRDF model, which does not require the parameters B_0 and h . In [35], this model was shown to exhibit a good fit with the measured data for desert sand (collected from Mountain Pass, California, USA), with incident zenith angles varying from 0° to 70° across the wavelength range of $400 - 2400nm$.

Chapter 4

Reflectance Measurements of Road Materials

Road surfaces are inherently heterogeneous owing to variations in material composition, aging, weathering, and surface texture. These variations cause spatial and temporal changes in reflectance characteristics that influence both the visual performance of lighting installations and the thermal behavior contributing to urban heat island effects. To better understand these changes, numerous field and laboratory optical measurements of road surface materials have been conducted in recent decades, focusing mainly on BRDF [6,20,21,33] and solar albedo [7,17,37,38]. The former quantifies the angular distribution of reflected light, which is critical for optimizing visibility, and the latter represents the fraction of solar reflected radiation which governs pavement thermal performance. This chapter provides the overview of the measurements conducted in the past twenty years in terms of BRDF and solar albedo of different materials of roads.

4.1 BRDF Measurements of Road Materials

In road surface analysis, BRDF measurements offer a detailed understanding of surface reflectance properties, that impacts not only human safety but also the performance of automated systems, such as LiDAR and camera-based sensors in autonomous vehicles.

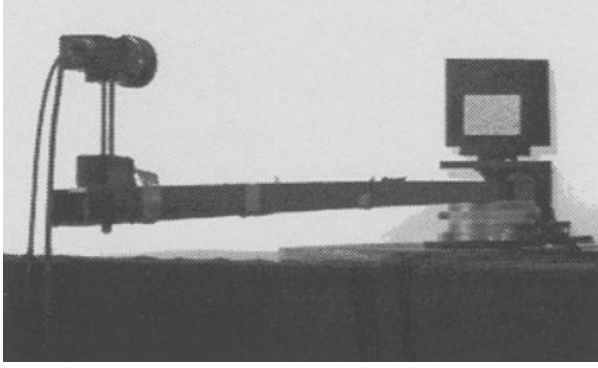
4.1.1 BRDF Measurement Set-up

The BRDF measurement systems for road surface can be broadly categorized into two types: laboratory-based and field-based approaches. The former is typically conducted under controlled environments where factors such as lighting, geometry, and surface conditions can be precisely controlled. The classic laboratory-based systems, such as gonireflectometer [8, 20, 33] and goniospectroradiometer if the detection is spectral [21, 35, 36], observe the same surface sample under varying observer and light source position, as seen in Fig 4.1. They are commonly composed of the goniometer used to change the angles of incidence and detection (e.g. by rotating the robot swing arms [8, 20, 35], as seen in Fig 4.1(a) and Fig 4.1(c)), the light source and the detection sensors (e.g. camera, spectroradiometer). In many studies, halogen lamp is used as the light source due to its spectrum close to solar spectrums [8, 21, 33, 35, 36].

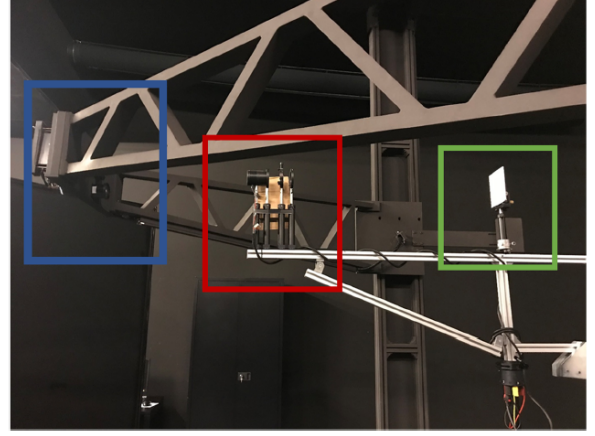
The latter is essential to obtain realistic data of road surface BRDF under actual environmental conditions, such as varying sunlight (from sunrise to sunset), weather (e.g. sunny, cloudy, rainy), and surface states (dry or wet). An example of such a setup is vehicle-based automotive measurement systems [6] (see in Fig 4.2(a)), where natural sunlight serves as the light source and detection sensor, such as camera, is mounted on the car's front window. Apart from this set-up, the lab-based set-up presented in Fig 4.1(c) is extended to measure the soil surface outside [35] by digging a small trench so that the pivot point of the pendulum arm coincided with the soil surface, as shown in Fig 4.2(b)

4.1.2 Former work on BRDF Measurement of Different Road Materials

In practical applications, road surfaces like asphalt and concrete are commonly made from a combination of aggregates and binders. The optical properties of these road materials have been extensively studied to support accurate modeling. To evaluate the accuracy of their diffuse reflectance model developed in 1993 [20], Oren and Nayar conducted several experiments restricted to the visible spectrum, using road-like materials as test samples, such as plaster and white sand. Their experiment set-up is given in Fig 4.1(a), where a 512×480 pixel charged-coupled device



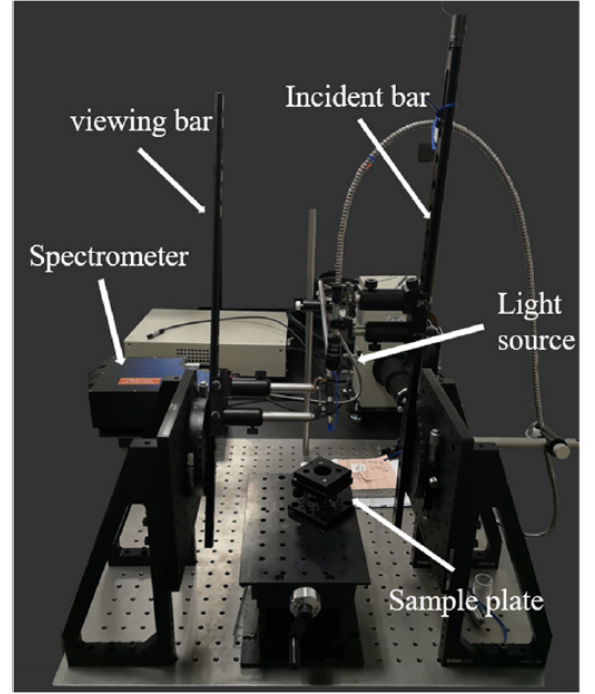
(a) Gonioreflectometer using a long beam



(b) Large near-field gonioreflectometer



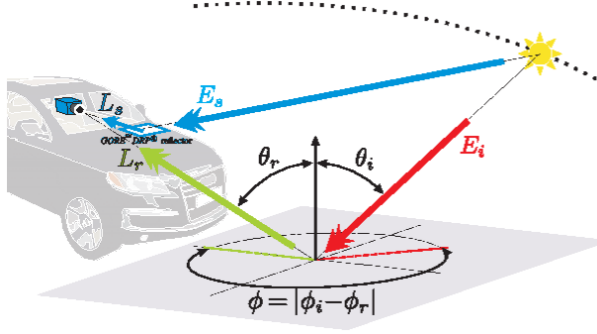
(c) Gonio-spectroradiometer using 2 swing arms



(d) Gonio-spectroradiometer using two bars

Figure 4.1: BRDF Laboratory measurement set-up

(CCD) camera as receiver is mounted at the end of a 6 foot long beam and 300 Watt incandescent light source is used to illuminate the sample. A pair of fitting parameters of their BRDF model (ON Model as described in Section (3.1.1)), diffuse albedo ρ and surface roughness σ were empirically chosen to obtain the best fit with the measured radiance. The optimal parameter values were found to be $\rho = 0.9$, $\sigma = 30^\circ$ for plaster, and $\rho = 0.8$, $\sigma = 35^\circ$ for white sand, as shown in Fig 4.3 and Fig 4.4 respectively. In both figures, the solid lines and the dotted points respectively show



(a) Vehicle-Mounted set-up



(b) Gonioreflectometer using 2 swing arms

Figure 4.2: BRDF Field-based measurement set-up

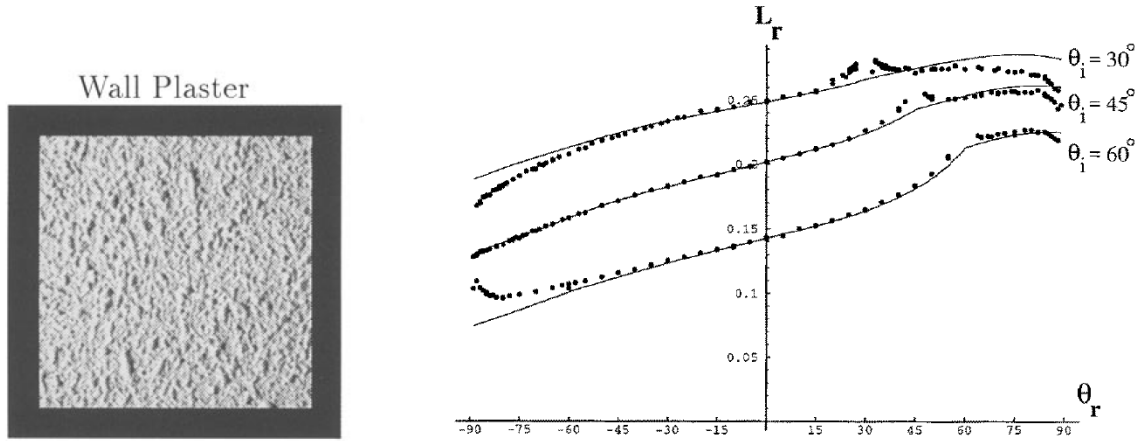


Figure 4.3: Plaster: Oren Nayar model fitting to measured radiance

the radiance predicted by ON model and the measured radiance. Notice that these measurements were made in the plane of incidence ($\varphi_r = \varphi_i$ and $\varphi_r = \varphi_i + \pi$ corresponding to negative and positive values of θ_r). For both plaster and white sand, the measured radiance shows a clear peak in the specular direction, where the this model exhibits poor fitting performance. This indicates that ON model is not well-suited for capturing specular reflectance.

To compensate for this deficiency, Meister extended ON model by linearly combining it with a specular reflectance model (TS model as described in Section (3.1.2)) to fit spectral BRDF measurement for asphalt respectively at $425nm$ and $660nm$ over the period from 1995 to 2000 [21], as

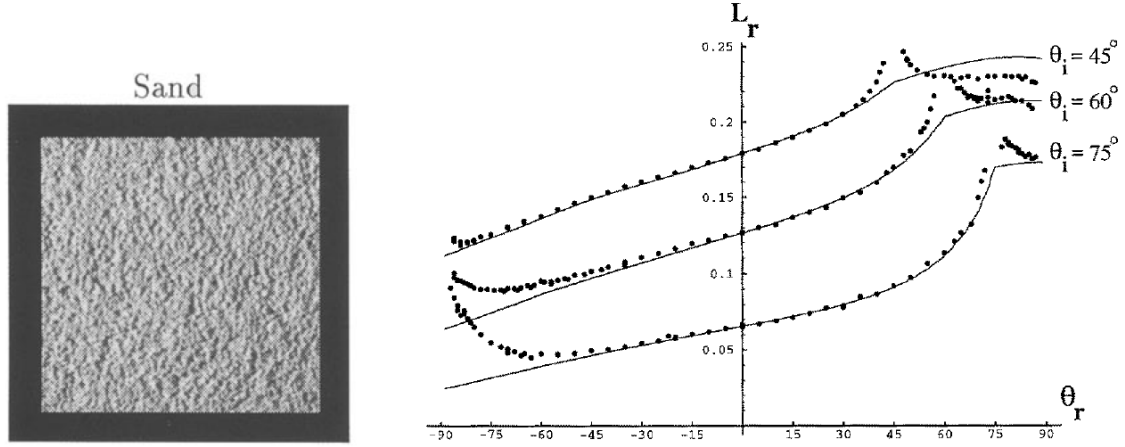


Figure 4.4: White sand: Oren Nayar model fitting to measured radiance

illuminated in Fig 4.5. In addition, he also applied a mixed model which linearly combined Lambertian model and TS model to fit the measured spectral BRDF of blue/red concrete respectively at the same wavelength, as shown in Fig 4.6 and Fig 4.7. These measurements were performed at the European Goniometric Facility (EGO) in Italy using a specially designed goniometer. Instead of employing a rotating robotic arm used by Oren and Nayar, this goniometer is constructed using two quarter arcs with a radius of 2 meters, which allow for the flexible mounting of a sensor and a light source [21]. To measure the spectral BRDF, this setup was modified by replacing the camera with an SE590 spectroradiometer, capable of capturing wavelengths in the range of 400 nm to 1100 nm. A 1000-watt halogen lamp was used as the light source due to its spectral similarity to sunlight. As observed from Fig 4.5 to Fig 4.7, the measured BRDFs were well fitted across most configurations.

In addition to the laboratory-based setup, Roser et al. conducted several experiments directly on natural concrete road surfaces using a three-dimensional geometric model of the automotive BRDF measurement system [6], as shown in Fig 4.2. The camera with known orientation was mounted behind the windshield, and sunlight was serving as the sole source of illumination. This system leverages single grayscale images, integrated with GPS and vehicle heading data, to estimate the reflectance properties of small road patches under both dry and damp conditions. The resulting measured data were subsequently fitted using the extended ON reflectance model that is same as the one used by Meister, as seen in Fig 4.8. This extended model and their parameters were able

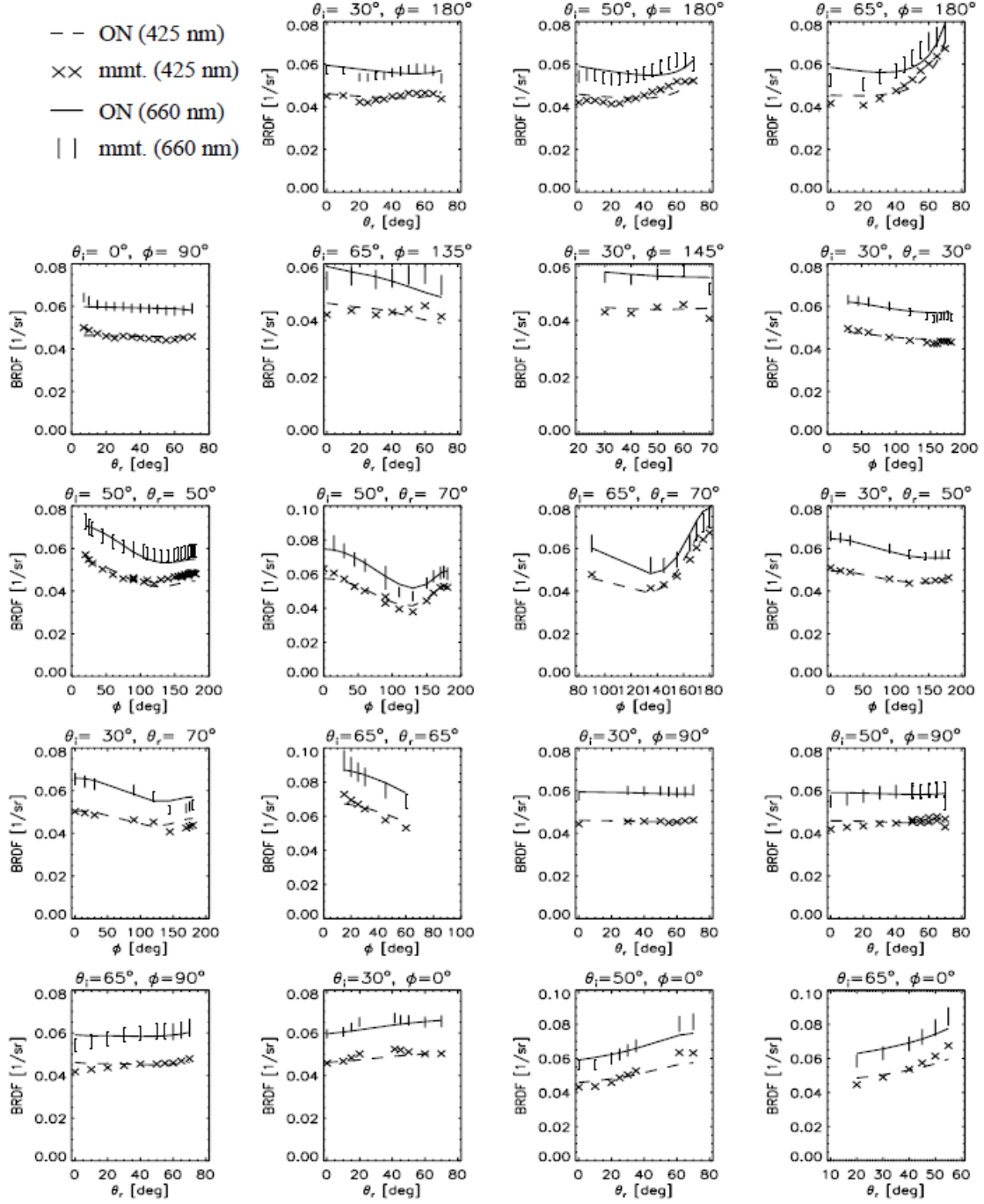


Figure 4.5: Asphalt: mixed reflectance model (ON + CT) fitting to measured BRDF

to successfully differentiate between different pavement reflection conditions.

In recent years, Wise et al. conducted extensive measurements on beach sands under darkened conditions [35], using a goniometer-based setup shown in Fig.4.1(c) that was transitioned to field use as illustrated in Fig 4.2(b). A spectroradiometer covering the 400 – 2400nm range and

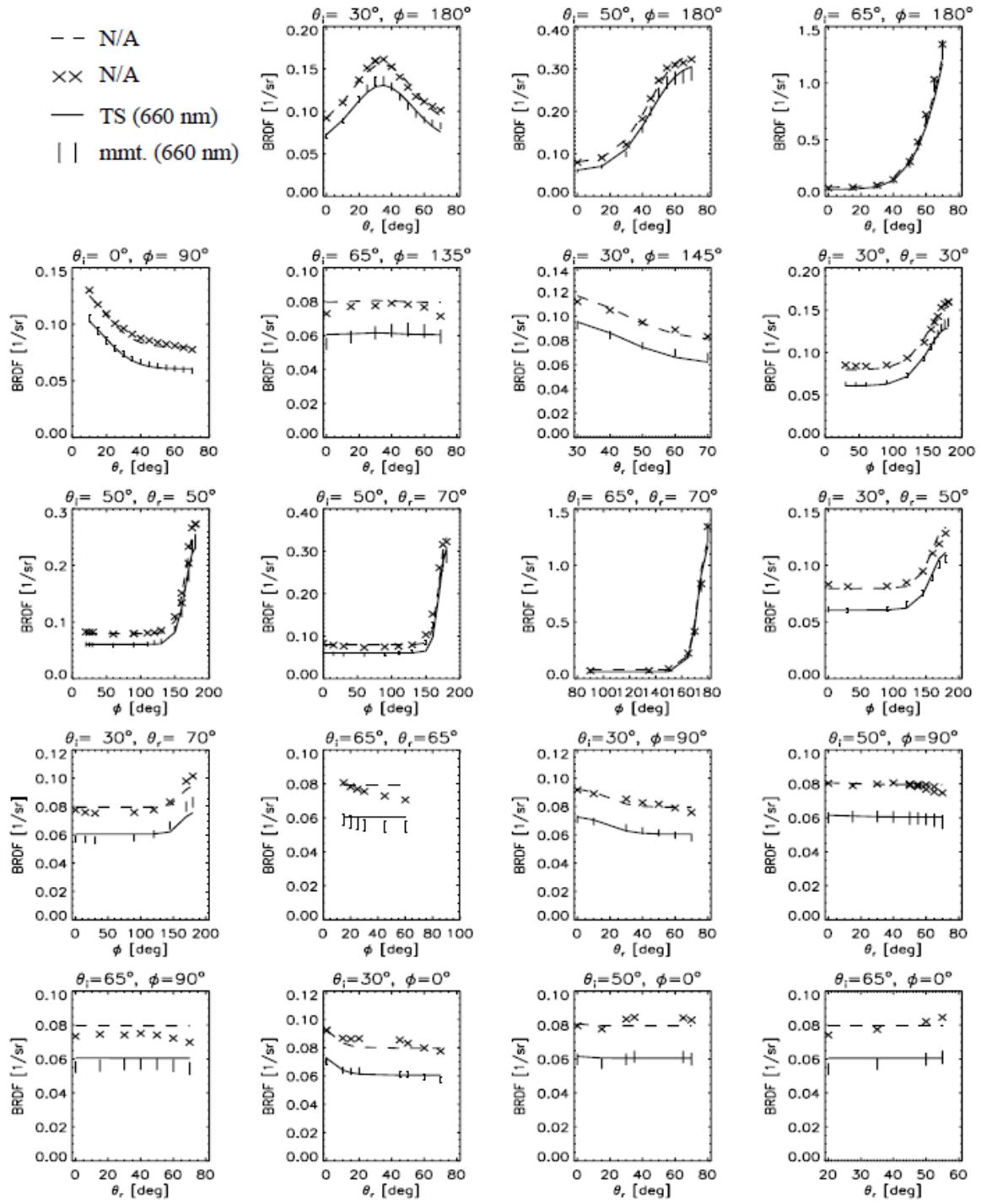


Figure 4.6: Blue concrete: mixed reflectance model (Lambertian + CT) fitting to measured BRDF

a halogen lamp were employed in their experiments, and were mounted on a portable, manually operated goniometer constructed from aluminum struts. In this goniometer design, the platform at the base measured 122×61 cm and supported two swing arms, measuring 46 cm and 66 cm in length,

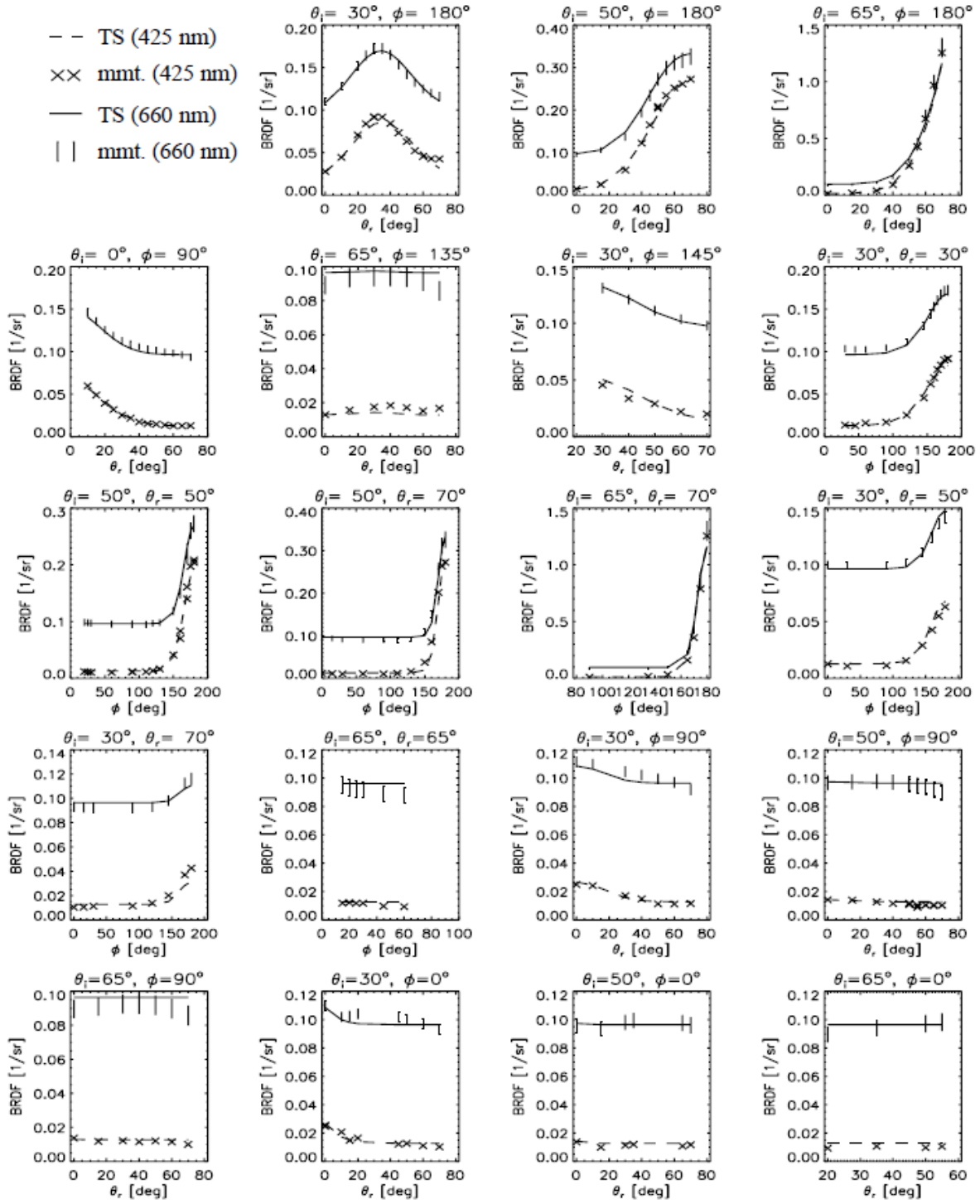


Figure 4.7: Red concrete: mixed reflectance model (Lambertian + TS) fitting to measured BRDF with a total system weight of approximately $9kg$. It allows for measuring the spectral BRDF over a 140-degree range ($-70^\circ - 70^\circ$) to within 3 degrees of backscatter. These measured BRDF data were fitted using Hapke's SHOE model described in Section (3.8) wherein a series expansion of

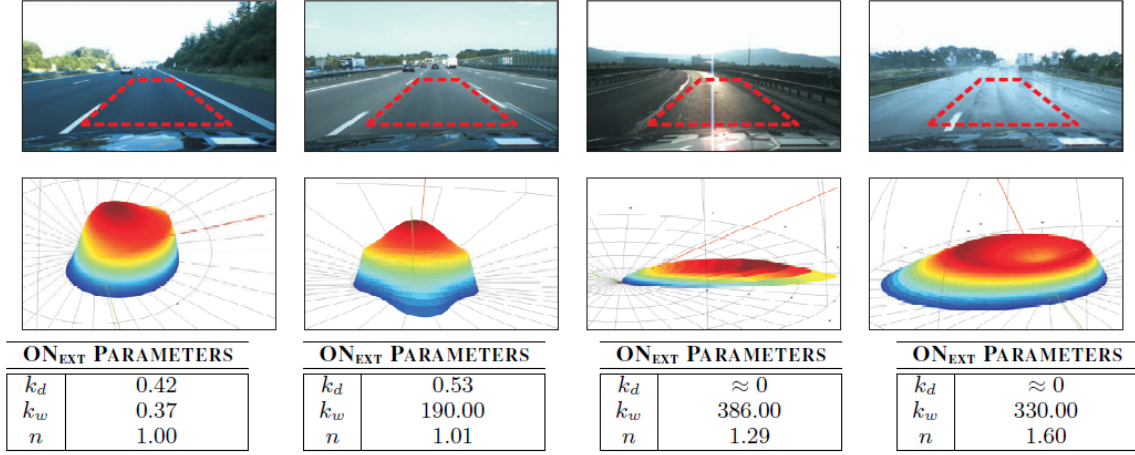


Figure 4.8: Concrete road: mixed reflectance model (ON + TS) fitting to measured BRDF

Legendre Polynomials was substituted for the angularly dependent backscatter function. The best-fit model BRDF was then integrated over the hemisphere to compute the Directional Hemispheric Reflectance (DHR), as shown in Fig 4.9. It can be observed that the integrated Lab BRDF (black) is almost overlapped with the measured DHR (blue), verifying the effectiveness of this BRDF model in capturing reflectivities of beach sands.

Apart from the beach sands, many spectral reflectance measurements on 13 different igneous rocks (seen in Fig.4.10) and their powders with different sizes in visible and near-infrared range from $400nm$ to $2500nm$ were performed by Zhuang et al. [36]. Similar to the experimental set-up in [35], the spectrometer and the light source were mounted on manually operated goniometer that consists of two rotary stages with bars, as shown in Fig 4.1(d). This set-up design is capable of adjusting the viewing and the incident zenith angles from 0° to 70° continuously. To emit the spectrum from $400nm$ to $2500nm$, the light source they utilized was highly stable Newport 66502-250Q-R1 quartz tungsten halogen lamp with an adjustable power range from 0-250W. The reflected light is collected by a bare fiber and transmitted to Spectral Evolution SR-2500 spectrometer. In their work, they measured respectively the intensities from the target sample and the reference Lab-sphere Spectralon plaque at incident zenith angle of 0° and a viewing zenith of 30° . Their ratio was considered as the relative reflectance, which is used to compute the reflectance factor (REFF) of this sample by multiplying the absolute Spectralon REFF values measured by RELAB [36]. These measurements were then fitted also using the Hapke's SHOE model, where the phase function is

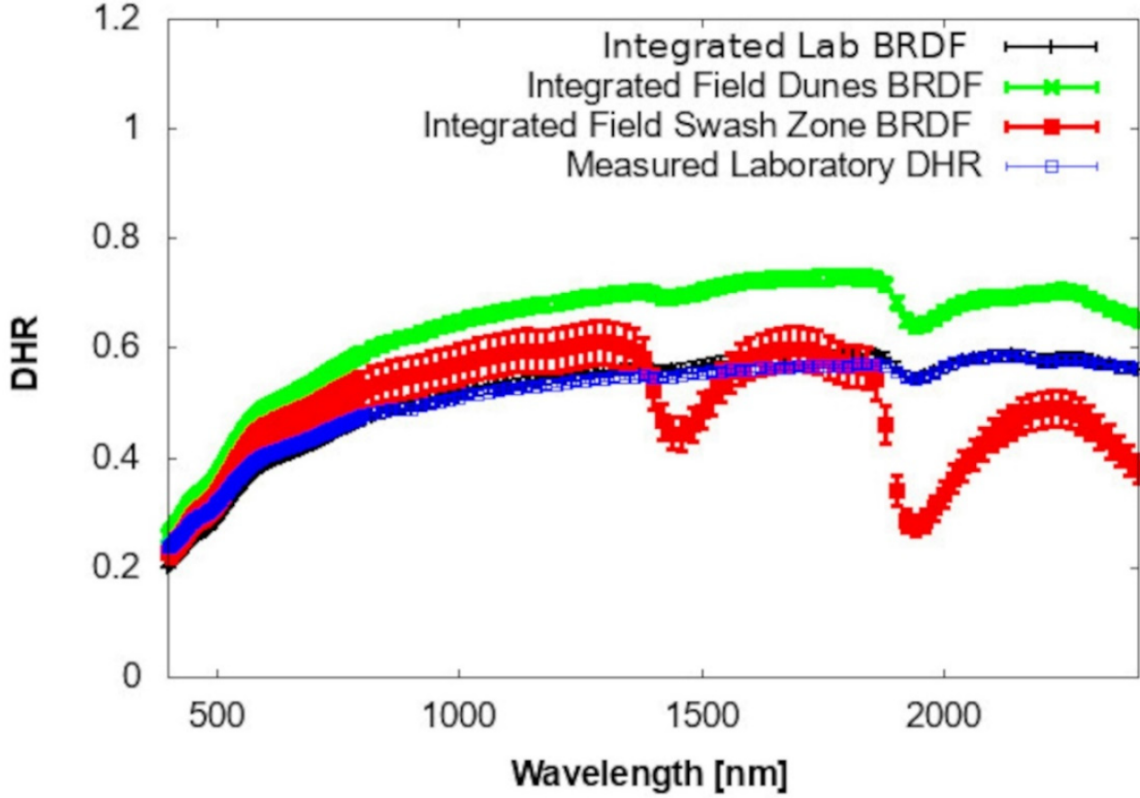


Figure 4.9: Chincoteague Island beach sand: Hapke’s SHOE model fitting to measured DHR

approximated by an empirical two-term Legendre polynomial. As illustrated in Fig 4.11, the fitted spectral reflectance curves for some samples with particle sizes exceeding $675\mu m$ are too similar to be clearly distinguished. It can also be observed that this model may not produce accurate spectral reflectance for all samples and particle sizes, likely due to its inherent simplicity and the assumption of a constant refractive index ($n = 1.6$) irrespective of wavelengths.

Alongside studies on road materials, the optical properties of road markings have attracted increasing attention in recent years. Spieringhs et al. [33] carried out several experiments on three different types of road markings (seen in Fig 4.12) using a Large Near-Field Goniometer (LNFG) developed by TechnoTeam, as shown in Fig.4.1(b). The elements highlighted in blue, red, and green boxes correspond to the luminance camera, the fixed light source, and the sample holder, respectively. In their measurements, a TechnoTeam LMK 98-4 high-tech calibrated luminance camera with a resolution of 1390×1040 pixels was mounted in the RIGO801 LNFG, which can be moved freely in order to allow for measurements in all desired viewing angles. Then the camera

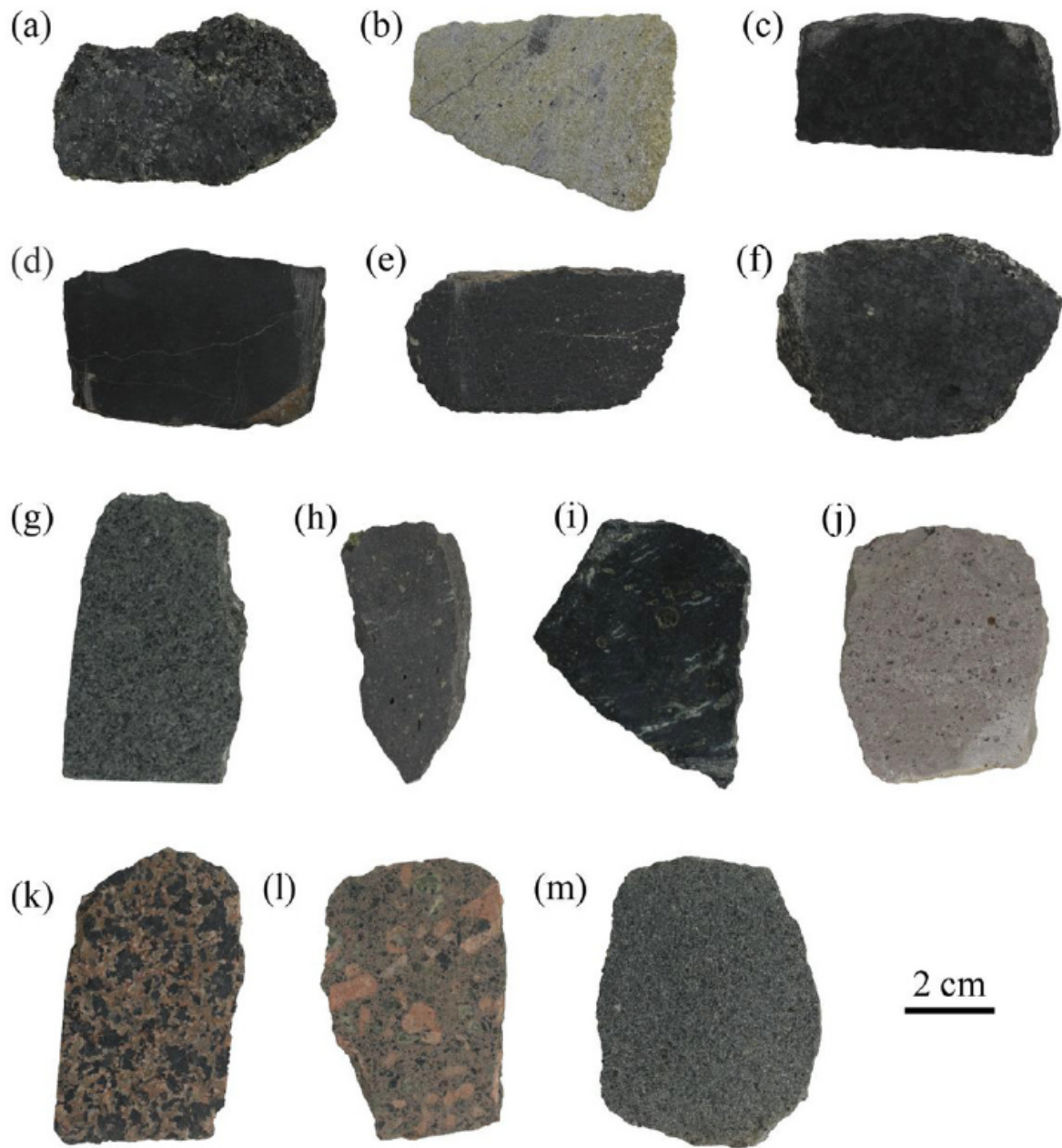


Figure 4.10: 13 igneous rocks slabs with a thickness of 1.5 cm: (a) Dunite; (b) Peridotite; (c) Olivine pyroxenolite; (d) Picrite porphyryrite; (e) Kimberlite; (f) Gabbro; (g) Diabase; (h) Olivine basalt; (i) Andesite basalt; (j) Trachyte; (k) Pyroxenite syenite; (l) Orthophyre; (m) Lamprophyre.

and the RIGO801 LNFG are connected to the computer in order to set the position of the arm of the LNFG via the TechnoTeam software and to record the luminance images. A QTH10(/M) Quartz Tungsten-Halogen 50W 12V lamp with a broadband emission between 400 and 2200nm

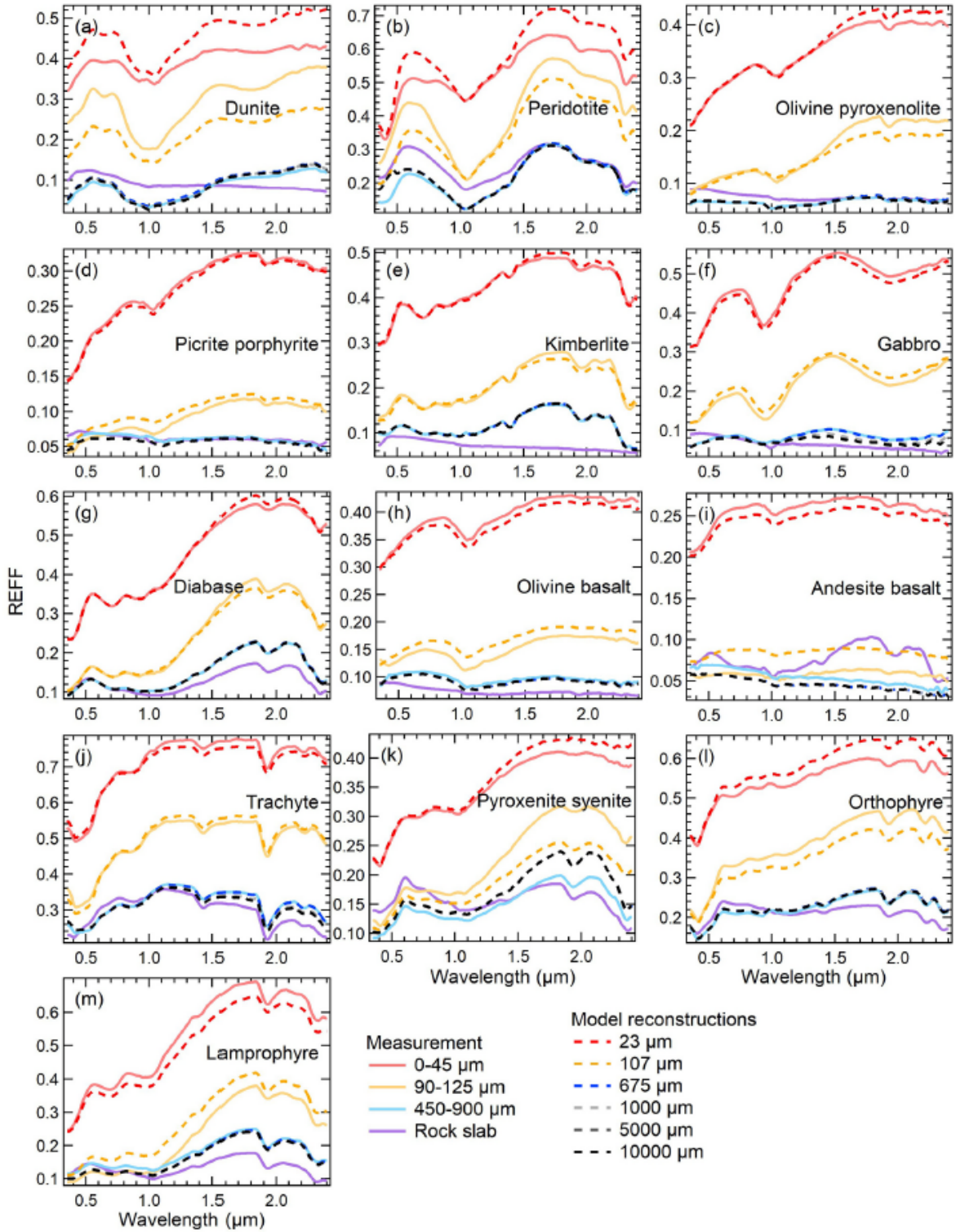


Figure 4.11: Igneous rocks: Hapke's SHOE model fitting to measured $REFF$

was employed as light source and connected to programmable Delta Elektronika SM1500 DC power system. Notice that the position of light source is fixed, indicating that it is impossible to allow



Figure 4.12: Three road marking samples containing glass beads: (1) SWARCO Limboplast *D480* with Megalux 0.6 – 1.5 KT14, (2) SWARCO Limboplast *D480* with *P21* 3 : 1, and (3) 3MStamark *A650*.

for all desired incident angles (θ, φ) by changing the position of light source. To accommodate this, an adjustable sample holder was designed to enable rotation around both vertical and horizontal axes. These measured data for 3 road markings were shown in Fig 4.13. As the incident angle θ_i increases, retro-reflection and specular reflection become more pronounced. Particularly at $\theta_i = 80^\circ$, the BRDF in the retro-direction nearly reaches or exceeds 1. To able to predict the BRDF at any incident angles (θ_i, φ_i) and viewing angles (θ_r, φ_r) , the authors employed the retro-phong model (described in Section (3.7)) to fit the measurements. A fitting example for road marking sample 1 was presented in Fig .4.14. Compared to the other models evaluated in [33], this model demonstrated better fitting performance.

4.2 Solar Albedo Measurements of Road Materials

4.2.1 Albedo Measurement set-up

Similar to BRDF measurements, there exist two primary approaches of measuring solar albedo: laboratory-based and field-based measurements. [17]. The former is carried out indoors using a

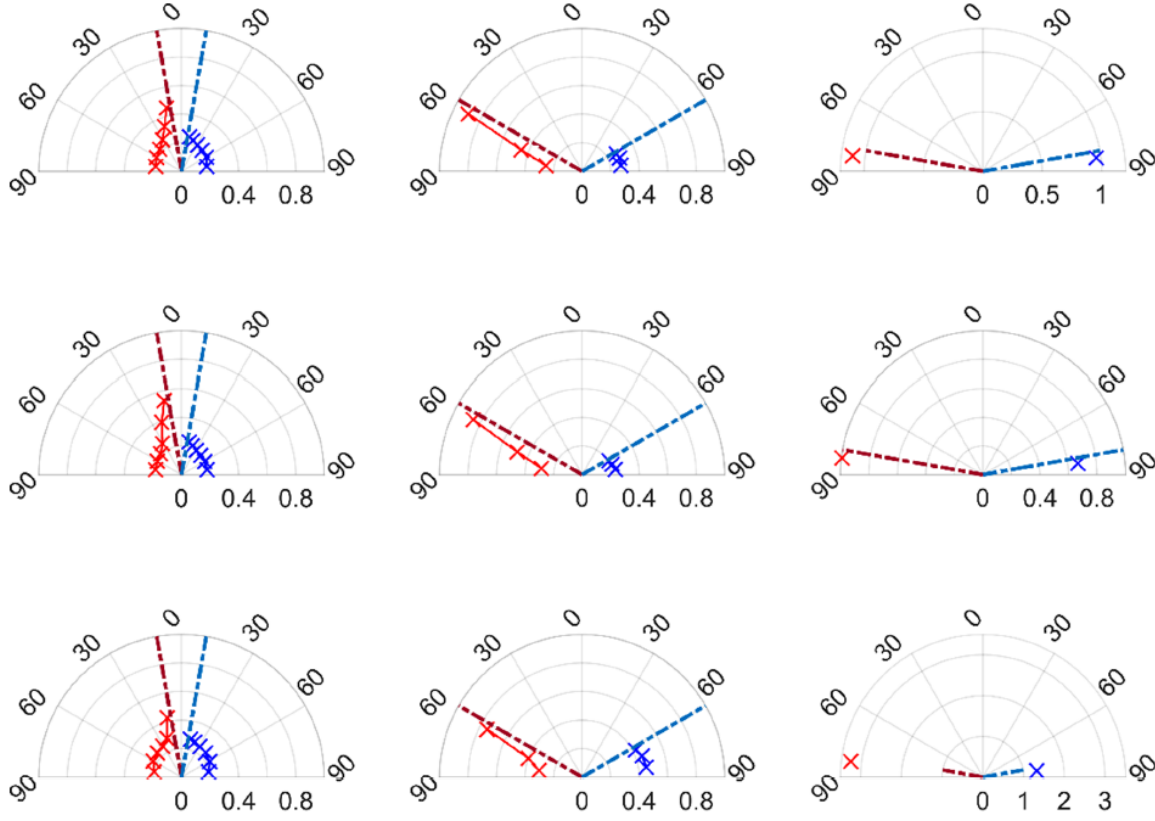


Figure 4.13: Measured BRDF: Top row for sample 1, middle row for sample 2, bottom row for sample 3. The 3 plots in a row represent an incident angle of $\theta_i = 0^\circ, 60^\circ, 80^\circ$ for a fixed φ_i from left to right, respectively. The crosses and dashed lines in red represent the retro-reflective hemisphere, and the ones in blue represent the specular hemisphere. The red dotted lines indicate the incident vectors. The radius of the polar diagrams is in sr° .

spectrophotometer equipped with integrating spheres, as following the standard test ASTM E903. The goal is to obtain the spectral reflectance which is an approximate estimate of solar albedo. This kind of test method is applicable to materials having both specular and diffuse optical properties.

While the latter is following ASTM 1918, providing an realistic measure of solar albedo, but highly depending on the weather conditions. It is conducted outside using an albedometer composing of sky-facing and target-facing pyranometers parallel to the test surface, as seen Fig 4.15, which are used to measure the incoming and reflected solar radiation respectively. The two pyranometers are mounted on an arm and a stand that centers the sensor at a height of $500mm$ above the target surface in order to minimize the effects of sensor, arm, and stand shadows on measured

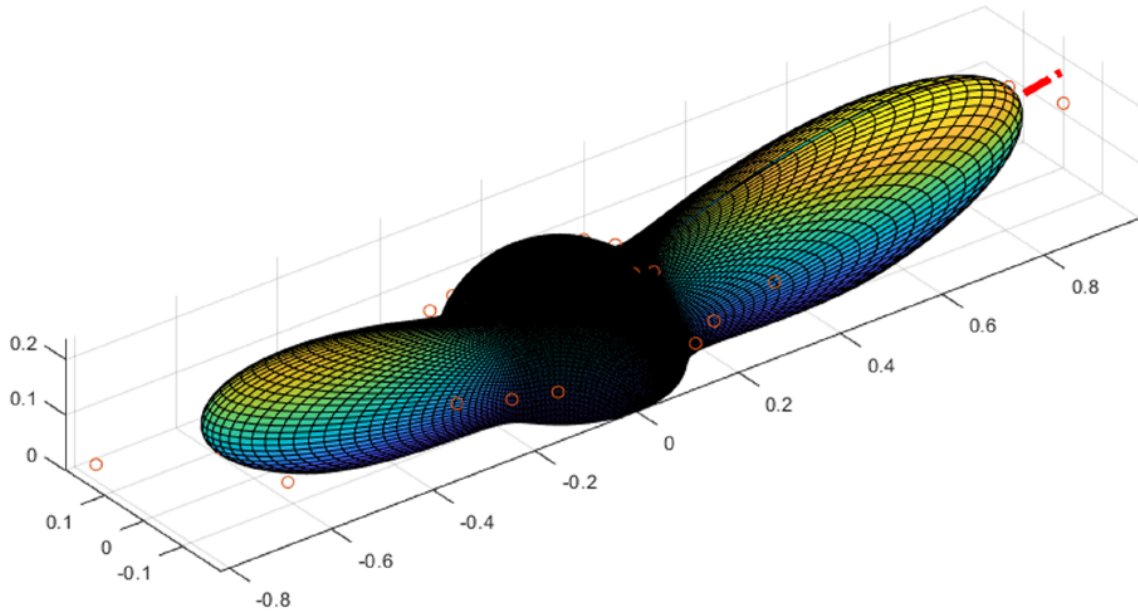


Figure 4.14: Road marking sample 1 (SWARCO Limboplast D480 with Megalux 0.6 – 1.5 KT14): Retro-Phong model fitting to measured BRDF. The dashed lines indicate the incident direction, the colored grids represent the fitted BRDF, the dots indicate the measured BRDFs in different viewing angles

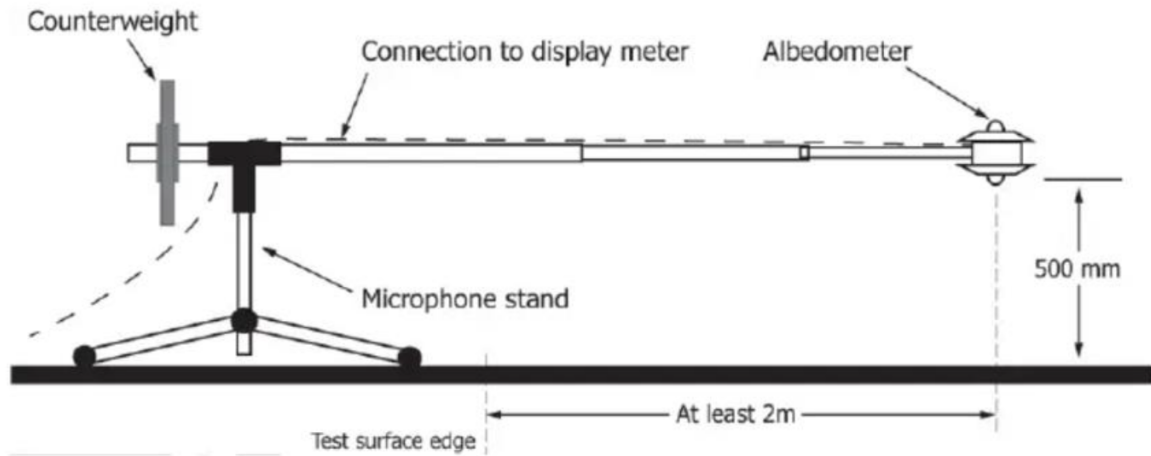


Figure 4.15: Schematic of the Albedometer and Its Support (provided in ASTM 1918-21)

reflected radiation. The horizontal distance from the center of the pyranometer to the edge of the test surface has to be at least $2m$. Besides, the arm and stand should be strong and cast the smallest possible shadow. This test method applies to low-sloped surface which are at least $4m$ in diameter (if circular) or at least $4m$ on each side (if rectangular). Notice that the angle of the

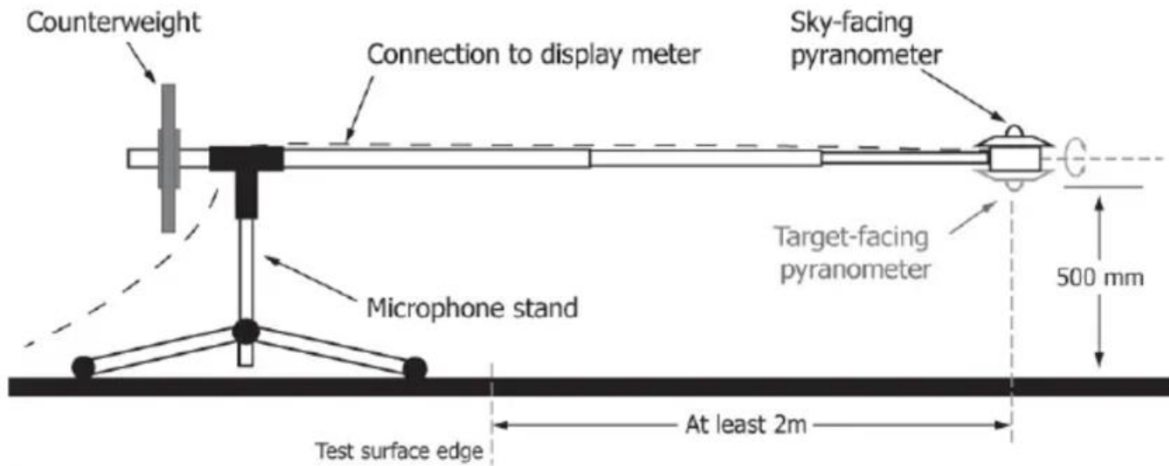


Figure 4.16: Schematic of the Pyranometer and Its Support (provided in ASTM 1918-21)

sun to the normal of the test surface should be less than 45° . Due to horizontal and low-sloped surfaces, the hours in summer for this test should be between 9.a.m and 3.p.m local standard time, which is when solar radiation is at least 70% of the value obtained at noon for that day. In winter, conducting the test should be between 10.a.m and 2.p.m local time, considering low solar incident angle. The albedometer will read both the incoming solar radiation and the reflected solar radiation simultaneously. To ensure the accuracy, each reading should be constant for at least 10s before recording the its values. Plus, at least 3 pairs of incoming and reflected radiation are required to be measured within 2 minutes. The calculated solar reflectance which is the ratio of the reflected radiation to the incoming radiation need to agree to within 0.01 in a reflectivity scale of 0 to 1.

The field-based method can be also conducted using only a pyranometer, as illustrated in Fig 4.16. Initially, the pyranometer is positioned facing upward and parallel to the test surface to measure the incoming solar radiation. After this measurement, the device is flipped to face downward to capture the reflected radiation. This reading process is quite similar to that of an albedometer. However, there is a key distinction due to time delay between reading incoming and reflected radiation. Unlike the albedometer, it requires at least three pairs of measurements of incoming and reflected radiation taken within a span of 10 minutes to ensure accuracy and reliability in the results for this one-pyranometer set-up.

4.2.2 Previous Work on Solar Albedo Measurements of Road Materials

Over the past few decades, many researchers performed the solar albedo measurements on road materials, in order to understand their ability to reflect solar radiation. Different from BRDF measurements, the measurements of solar albedo offers a practical and integrated assessment of surface reflectivity over the whole hemisphere. In the 1980's, Blumthaler et al. investigated the solar albedo of some road materials (e.g., asphalt, rock, stream sand, and limestone) over the $0.3 - 3\mu m$ wavelength range [37], as summarized in Table 4.1. These values were obtained through many measurements carried out using a star-pyranometer under both direct sunlight and cloudy conditions, with no essential differences observed between the two cases. At each measurement site, the albedo value was determined as the mean of five individual readings. The measured albedo values varied considerably among the materials, with asphalt exhibiting the lowest albedo (0.06-0.15, average 0.10) and limestone the highest (0.20-0.32, average 0.26).

Table 4.1: Solar albedo of various road materials					
Road Materials	Number of sites of Measurements	Solar albedo			
		Min	Max	Mean	
Asphalt	12	0.06	0.15	0.106	
Primitive rock	7	0.12	0.16	0.144	
Stream sand	8	0.22	0.24	0.238	
Stream sand	15	0.20	0.32	0.260	

Later, Kushari et al. utilized two coupled-pyranometers (LP PYRA 05 made by Hotek Technologies, seen in Fig 4.17) to conducted field measurements on road sections in Bangkok Metropolitan's district [7], in order to gather albedo data from $0.3 - 3\mu m$ wavelength range. This dual-faced sensor (also known as albedometer) was able to capture the incoming and reflected solar radiation in the same time, which were then read through a multi channel data logger (from Campbell Scientific), as illustrated in Fig .4.17. Each reading last for a period of 1 to 2 minutes. All these measurements were performed under direct sunlight in clear day from $10am$ to $4pm$. A total of 149 measurement

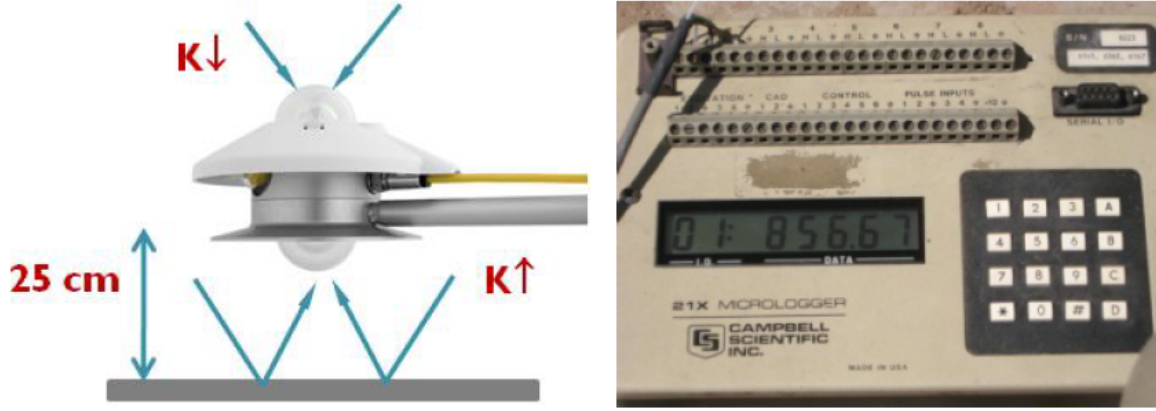


Figure 4.17: Two coupled-pyranometers (left) and a multi channel data logger

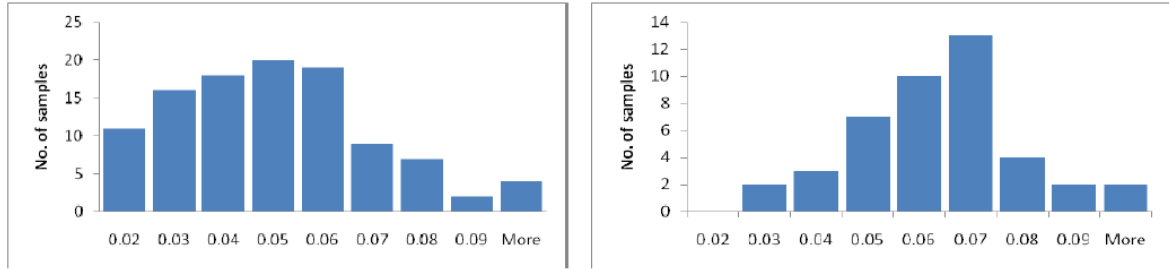


Figure 4.18: Albedo distribution of 106 asphalt samples (left) and 43 concrete samples (right)

points were selected, including 106 samples from asphalt pavements and 43 from concrete pavements. The collected albedo data for the types of pavements are summarized in Fig .4.18, showing that both asphalt and concrete exhibit low albedo values. The mean albedo of the former is 0.045, substantially lower than the value reported in [37] (0.106). In comparison, the latter demonstrated a higher mean albedo of 0.061.

A similar albedometer [17] was adapted for the laboratory measurements shown in Fig.4.19, focusing on three asphalt mixtures (Fig.4.20) and three portland cement concrete (Fig 4.21) with different roughness level in the same wavelength range. In this experimental set-up, the solar radiation was emitted from the infrared lamp with wavelength of $0.3 - 3\mu m$. Unlike the field measurements in [7], data for incident and reflected radiation were not collected simultaneously. The lamp and the albedometer were first positioned at the same height above the samples, in order to measure reflected radiation from the lower pyranometer every 30 seconds over a period of 3 minutes. The final recorded reflected is the mean value of these readings. Then the albedometer



Figure 4.19: Albedo lab-based measurement set-up

was moved to the position of the sample, and the incident radiation from upper pyranometer was collected. The asphalt mixture samples were made of crushed basalt aggregate, limestone filler, and modified asphalt, while the Portland cement concrete was made of aggregate, cement, and sand. Their measured albedo are summarized in Fig.4.22. We can clearly observe that the later mixture (albedo from 0.228 to 0.264) has higher reflectance than the former (albedo 0.0546 to 0.0611). Moreover, the albedo values of the asphalt mixture are consistent with those published in [7, 37], providing a reliable reference for future investigations.

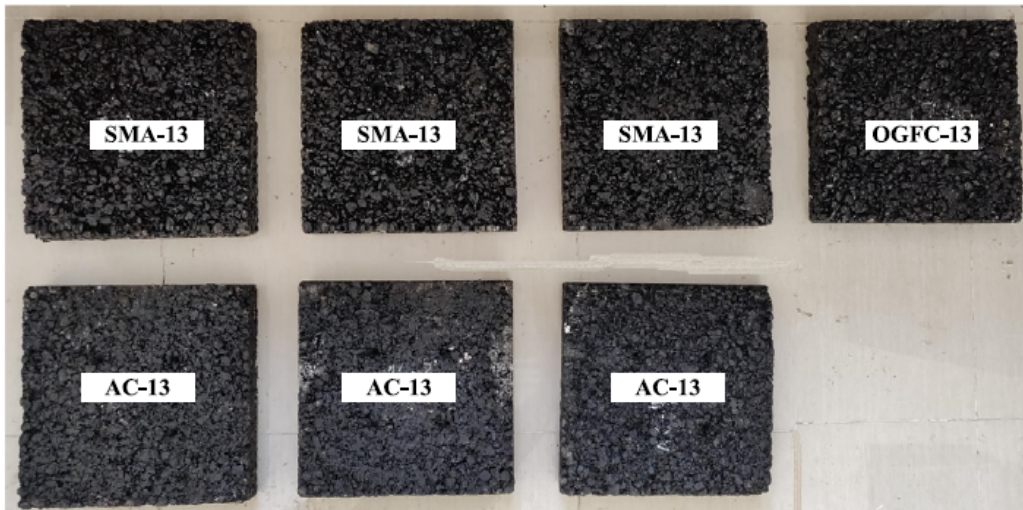


Figure 4.20: 3 types of asphalt mixtures

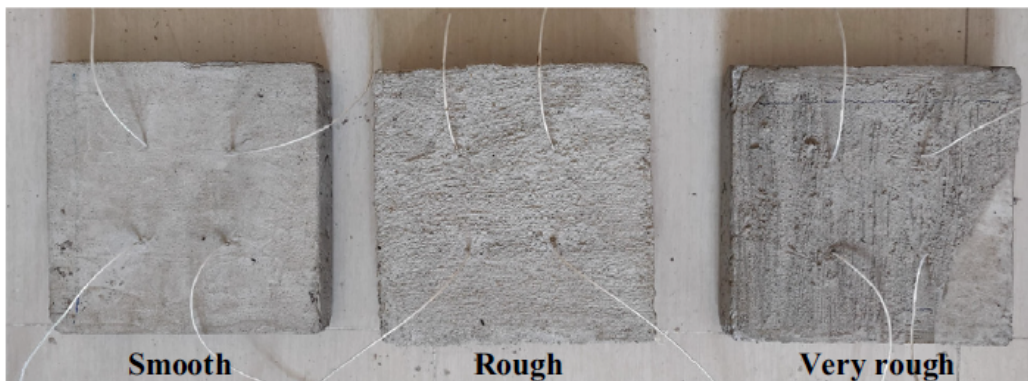


Figure 4.21: portland cement concrete (PCC)

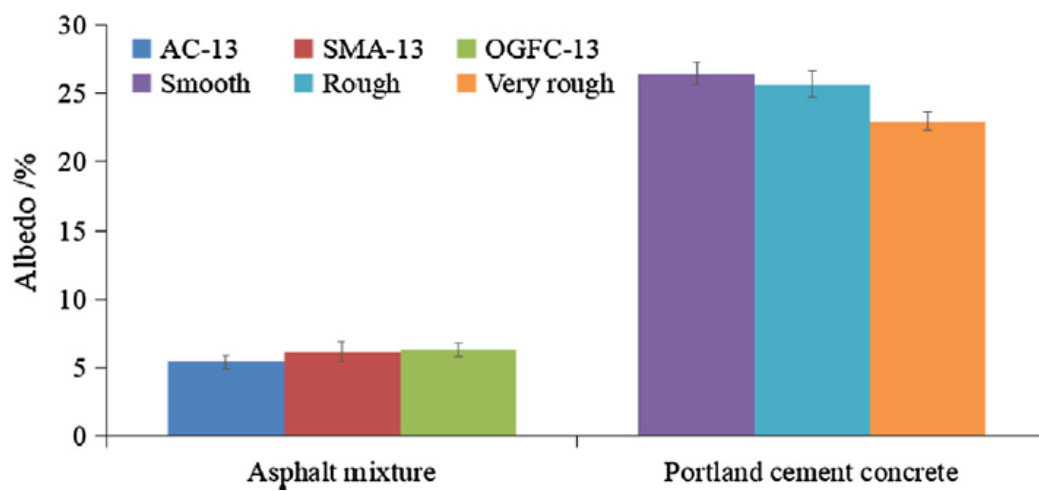


Figure 4.22: Albedo of asphalt mixtures and PCC without coating materials

Chapter 5

Spectral BRDF Measurement of road samples

The design and operation of a transport system require careful consideration of numerous things, such as the installation of public lighting, minimizing light pollution, temperature control, and ensuring the visibility of road markings. Central to addressing these considerations is to know the reflectance of the road surface, which necessitates simulations or measurements. However, conducting these simulations or measurements is often costly due to the time requirements and the need for specialized equipment. A key question arises: Can the reflectance of a road surface be predicted if the formulation of the surface and the reflectance of its individual components are known? The relationship between solar albedo and BRDF provides a pathway to answering this question. Equations (2.20) and (2.19) illustrate how solar albedo can be derived from BRDF. This indicates that if the BRDF model can predict the BRDF for any given direction of incidence and observation, then it can also predict the solar albedo of the surface. Chapter 3 provides several BRDF models expressed as functions of incident and viewing angles. However, these models often require additional parameters that depend on the surface's characteristics. For instance, the ON model requires knowledge of the diffuse albedo (ρ) and surface roughness (σ). For each single-material component, we can calibrate a reflectance model by fitting it to spectral BRDF measurements and extracting the relevant parameters. Once BRDF models are established for

each individual component, they can be combined to construct a hybrid BRDF model for the multi-material pavement. This model can then be fitted to the BRDF measurements to determine the weighting factors associated with each component. Accordingly, the BRDF of this pavement can be predicted for any direction of incidence and observation. However, achieving this lies in obtaining accurate and reliable spectral BRDF measurements, which serve as essential input to fitting process.

To support this, this chapter first introduces 2 formulations of road samples and their constituent components. Then it provides a spectral BRDF measurement method using the equipments developed by Cerema to measure their BRDF. This approach is validated first through BRDF measurements on Spectralon (a material with well-known Lambertian reflection model and a given diffuse albedo), and then comparison with results obtained from Université Gustave Eiffel (UGE). The measured spectral BRDF results for both the composite (mix-material) and individual (single-material) samples are presented and analyzed in the last section.

5.1 Road samples

This section first presents 4 different formulations of road samples, along with their individual constituent materials, as provided by a French company. In order to ensure reliable BRDF measurements for each single-component sample, it is required that the surface to be measured must be flat. For this purpose, this section then describes how to construct such samples.

5.1.1 Two Road formula

In this study, we chose 2 different formulations of road samples (provided by a French company - Spie Batignolles), along with their individual constituent materials (seen in Table 5.1). In order to ensure reliable BRDF measurements for each single-component sample, it requires that the surface to be measured must be flat, as shown in Figure 5.1. Each formulation incorporates limestone filler, a very fine powder present in small proportions. As such, the impact of limestone filler has been disregarded in the analysis. Formulations F2 and F3 share similar component structures. The main difference between them is in the binder: F2 uses bitumen, while F3 employs a pigmented synthetic

binder TiO_2 . Across all single-component samples, the materials can be broadly classified into two categories: binders and aggregates. The binders include bitumen and the synthetic binder. The aggregates comprise two main types:

- Sorrèze limestone (0/2 mm),
- Lazard rock with two different size regions (2/6.3 mm and 6.3/10 mm).

For clarity, these two types Lazard are hereafter referred to as Lazard 2/6 and Lazard 6/10, respectively. It is difficult to perform direct measurements on binders, as creep occurs and the surface does remain perfectly planar. So we combine the Sorrèze limestone with bitumen and synthetic binder respectively. As such, we have two different mastics corresponding to F2 and F3 provided by the same French company (Spie Batignolles), as seen in Figure 5.1.

Table 5.1: Road formula (massive percentage)

	F2	F3
Limestone filler	2.2%	1.4%
TiO_2	0.0%	0.5%
Bitumen	5.3%	0.0%
Synthetic binder	0.0%	5.4%
Sorrèze limestone (0/2)	28.3%	27.5%
Lazard (2/6)	19.5%	21.0%
Lazard (6/10)	44.7%	44.2%
Total	100.0%	100.0%

5.1.2 Construction of single-material samples

The procedure for fabricating a one-component sample with a flat surface is as follows:

1. Prepare all the materials and tools including:
 - 3 liquid products (as illuminated in Fig 5.2): Renlease QZ511, REN HY956 from Ren-Shape and Resin - RENLAM MS-1

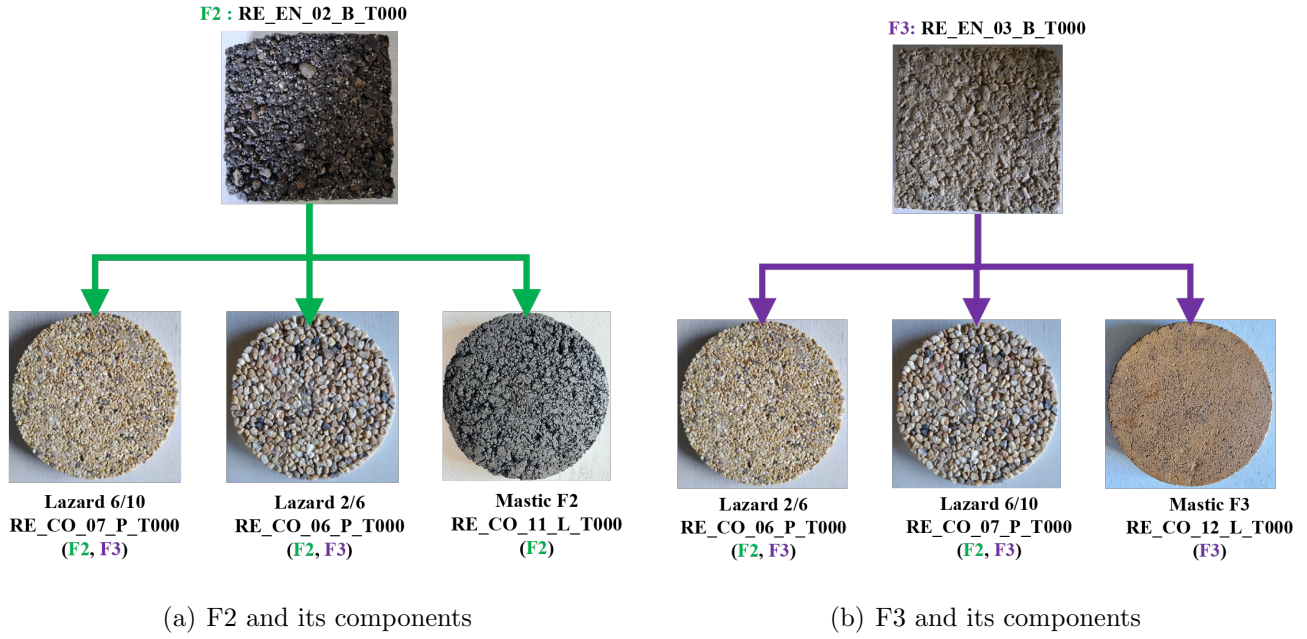


Figure 5.1: Two road formulations

- Aluminum mould, as seen in Fig 5.3(a)
 - Brush
 - Stainless steel spatula
 - Mixing container
 - Clean aggregates
 - Fontainebleau sands
2. Clean the mould, then install the aluminum mould and secure it with 2 screws.
 3. Coating the mould with unmold liquid Renlease QZ511 using the brush, as seen in Fig 5.3(b).
 4. Put a single layer of aggregates, making sure they are as close together as possible, as seen in Fig 5.4(a).
 5. Place a layer of sand on top of the aggregate to prevent the resin from passing through the pores between the aggregates, as shown in Fig 5.4(b).
 6. Put 300g of RENLAM MS-1 resin and 100g of REN HY956 hardener in the mixing container, and mix them together, then put in 800g of Fontainebleau sand, as seen in Fig 5.5(a).

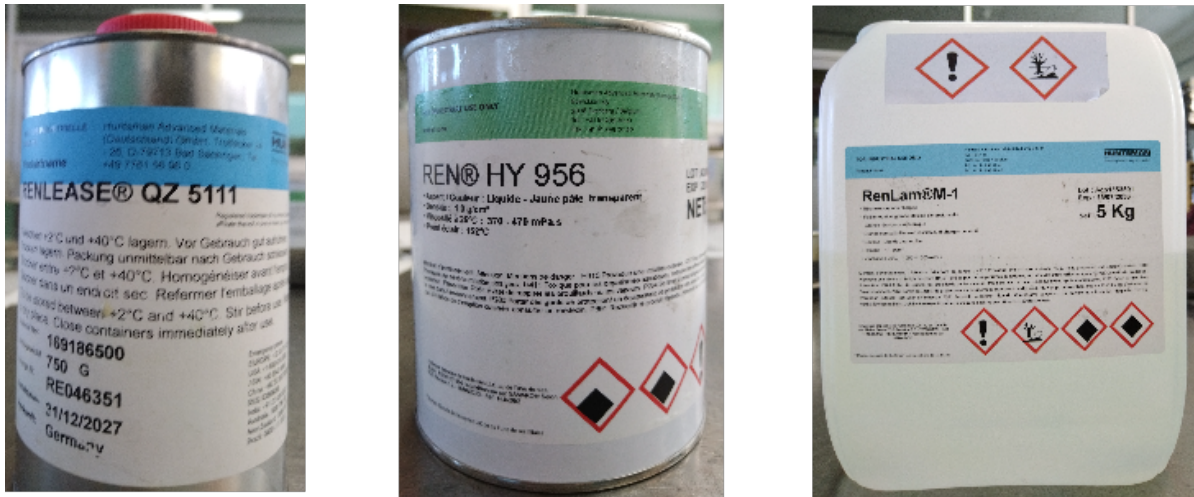
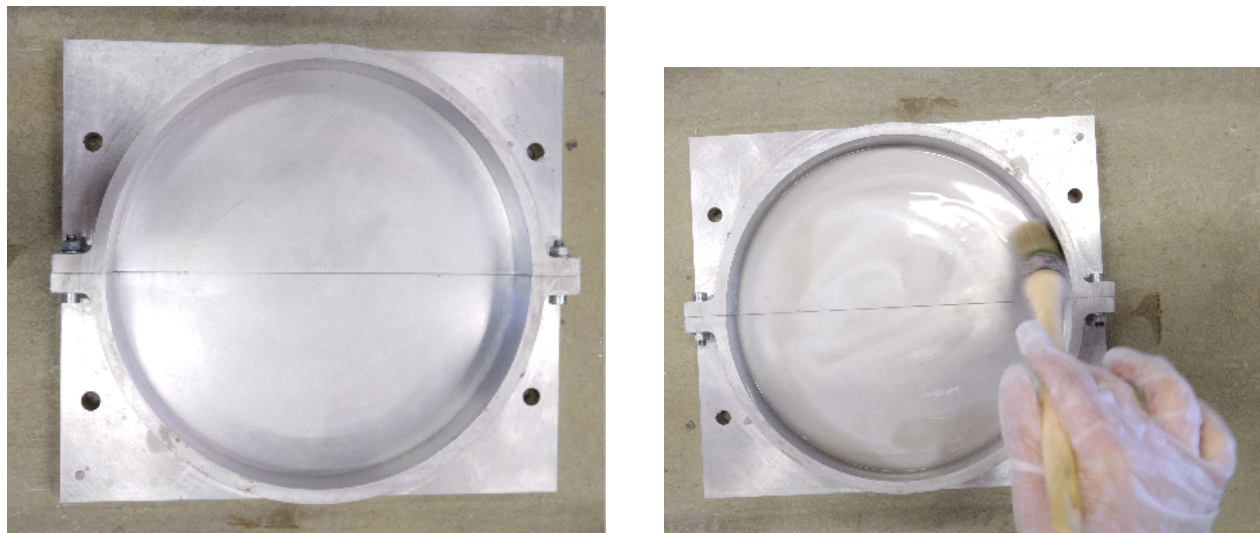


Figure 5.2: 3 liquid products: Unmould liquid - Renlease QZ511 (left), Hardener - REN HY956 from RenShape (middle), Resin - RENLAM MS-1 (right)

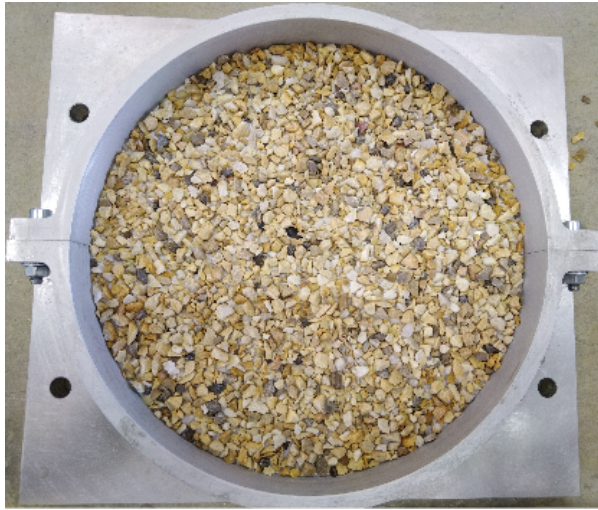


(a) Clean aluminum mould

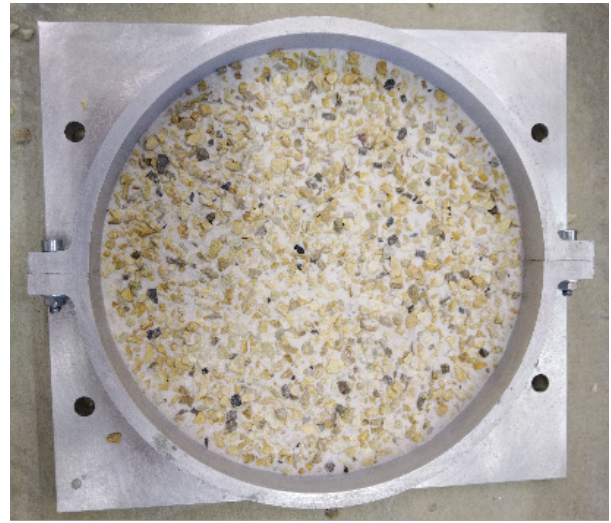
(b) Coating aluminum mould

Figure 5.3: Aluminum mould

7. Mix the sands with the liquids in the container until homogenous, then leave them (see Fig 5.5(b)) for about 1 hour to warm up.
8. Pour the homogenous glue into the mould until it is full, then make sure the top surface is flat and leave to rest for 8 hours, as seen in Fig 5.6(a)
9. Unmould this mould and remove the sand from the surface of the aggregates, as shown in Fig 5.6(b).



(a) Put a single layar of aggregates on the mould



(b) Put a single layar of sands on the aggregates

Figure 5.4: Placing the aggregates on the mould

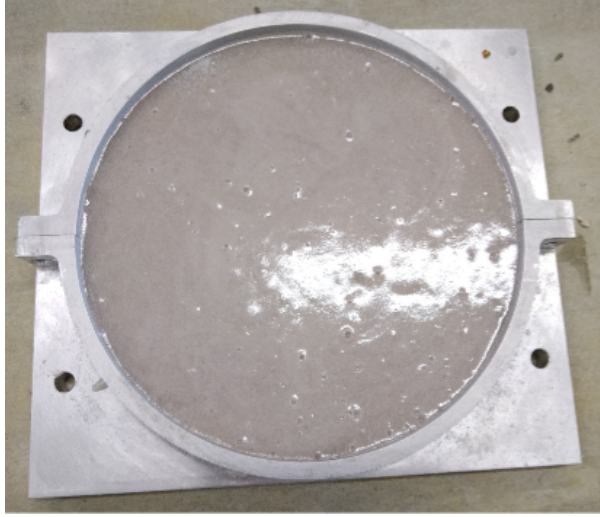


(a) Put all materials in the container



(b) Homogenous glue after mixing

Figure 5.5: Making the glue



(a) Pour the glue on the mould



(b) Final sample

Figure 5.6: Unmold

5.2 Spectral BRDF Measurement

5.2.1 Measurement set-up

The set-up developed by Cerema [39, 40] was initially designed for measuring photometric BRDF in accordance with International Commission on Illumination (CIE) recommendations, as shown in Figure 5.8. It consists of 3 elements: light source, the sample holder and the camera. A halogen lamp with a broadband spectral emission ranging from $350nm$ to $2500nm$ is employed as the illumination source, and its spectrum is illustrated in Figure 5.7. It is mounted on a circular metal arc with a radius of $2.3m$, allowing the sample to be illuminated at a constant distance from various zenith angles γ , ranging from vertical ($\gamma = 0^\circ$) to grazing angles. The detection system comprises a camera calibrated in photometric luminance and mounted on a second circular metal arc with a radius of $1.9m$, which allows the selection of any observation zenith angle (α). This camera is attached to the end of a rotating metal arm ($1.8m$) and oriented toward the sample positioned along the arm's axis, ensuring that the surface is always observed from the same viewpoint. By rotating this arm, the azimuthal angle (β) between the illumination and observation planes can be varied. The sample holder is positioned at another side of this rotating arm, and can be rotated

around it to modify the azimuth angle δ between the observation plane and the axis of the sample (x axis). The joint movement of these 3 elements is performed automatically by a computer, which allows the light reflected by the sample surface to be measured under any lighting and observation configuration.

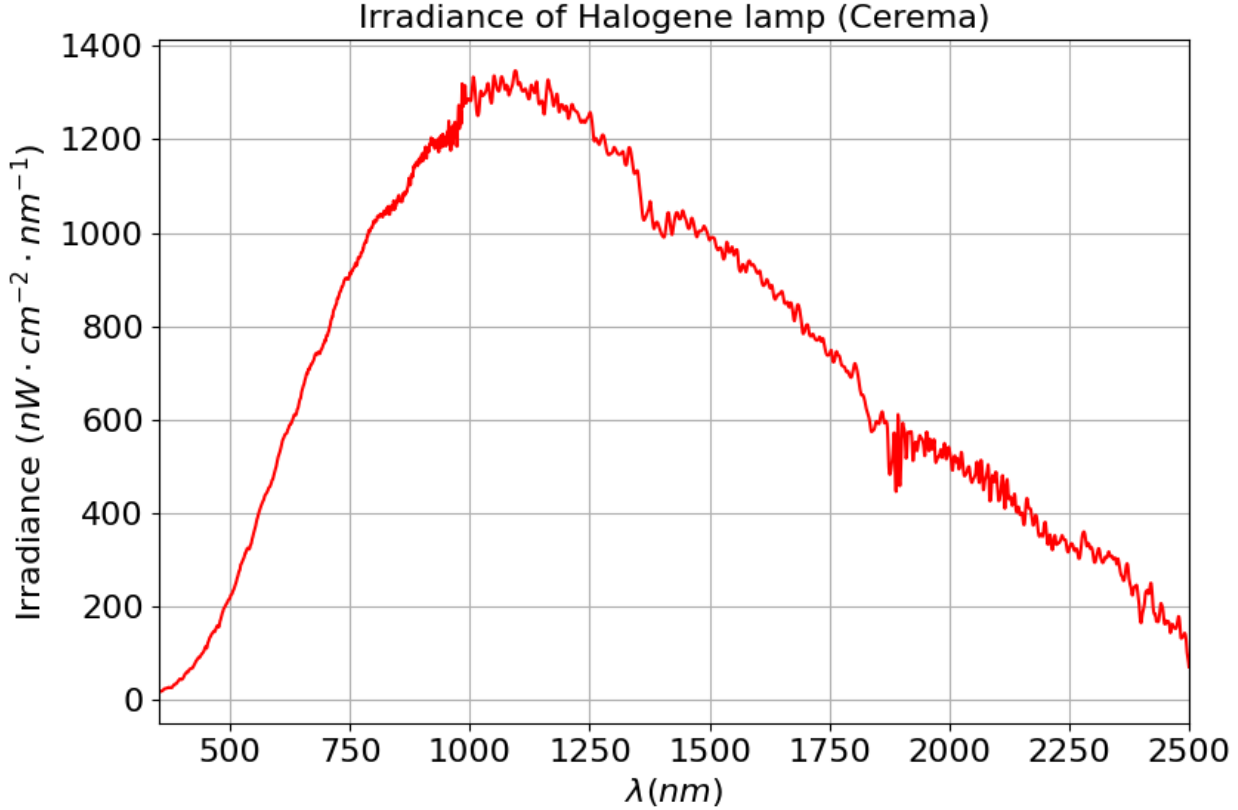


Figure 5.7: Spectrum of halogene lamp (Cerema)

As known, the camera is typically used to capture the photometric luminance. If we want to measure the spectral BRDF of roads, we need a sensor to be able to detect the spectral radiance, which is spectroradiometer. As seen in Figure 5.10, the new detection systems is placed at the same rotating arm, and consists of the lens, the lens support, the spectroradiometer, and the optical cable (used to connect the lens and the spectroradiometer). The camera in the original set-up is replaced by a lens connected with the spectroradiometer through a optical cable. Of course, to adjust the observation zenith angle is less flexible compared to the original set-up because we need to manually adjust the height of the lens support. Except this, the rest is still controlled by the computer.

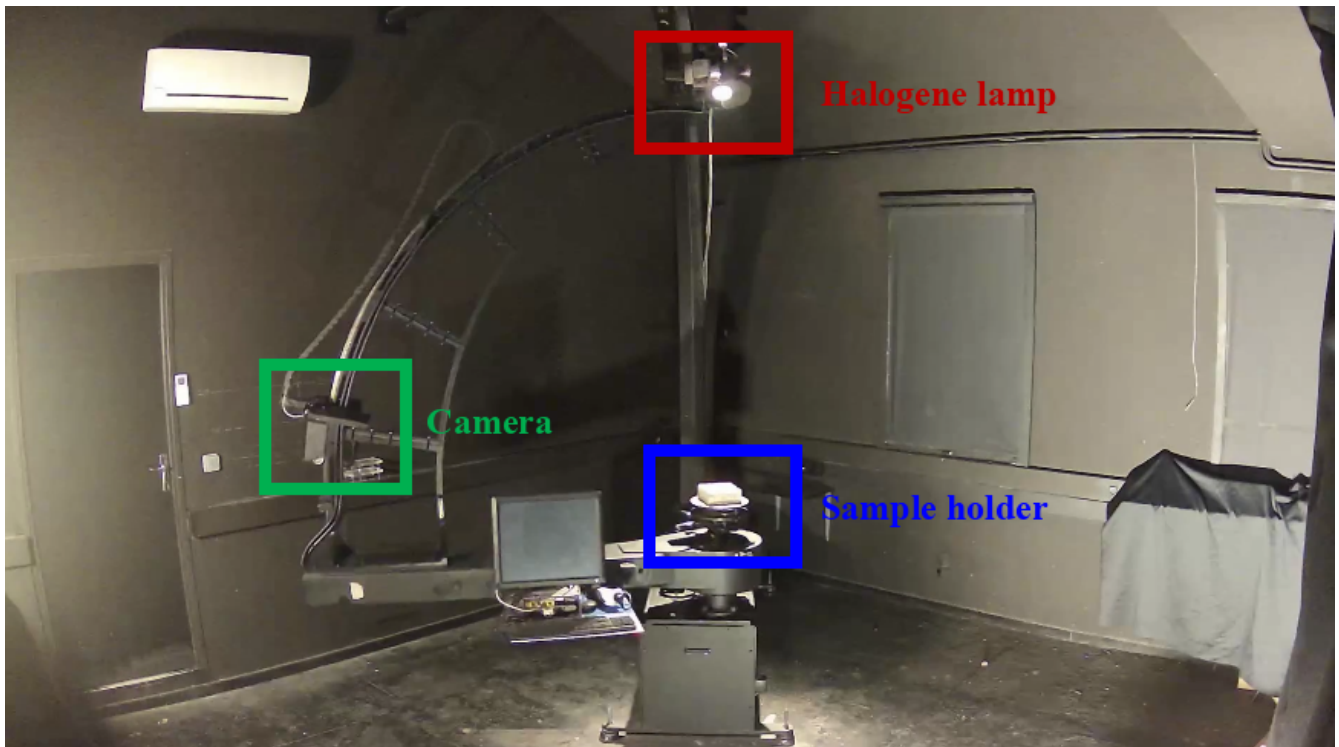


Figure 5.8: Gonioreflectometer (Cerema)

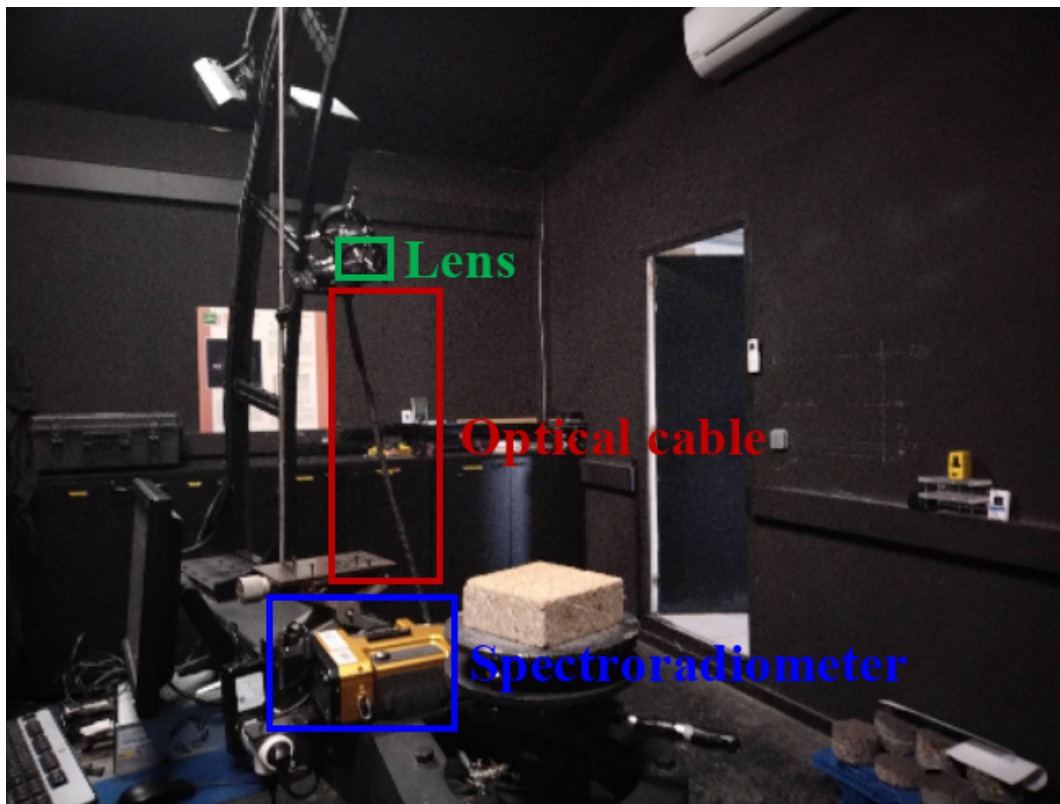


Figure 5.9: Gonio-spectroradiometer reception (Cerema)

5.2.2 Methodology

To have a better understanding of the measurement method, the simplified set-up is as shown in Figure 5.10. We have the main configuration parameters:

- γ : the incident zenith angle (the angle between the normal and the illumination plane);
- α : the observation zenith angle (the angle between the normal and the observation plane);
- β : the azimuth angle between the illumination and observation planes;
- δ : the azimuth angle between the observation plane and the axis of the sample (x axis), not marked in the Figure 5.10;
- ω : the Field Of View (FOV) of lens;
- l : the distance between the lens center and the sample center, limited to the length of the rotating arm ($< 1.8m$);
- H : the height of the lens center relative to the horizontal plane of the sample surface, depending on l and α ;
- D : the diameter of light spot on the sample surface emitted from the lens center, depending on ω , l and α .

Since the angles γ, β, δ can be adjusted automatically by the computer and not limited to measurement environment, so we could choose any values. However, the parameters l , D and H are constrained to the length of the rotating arm, the size of the sample, and the height of the measurement room, respectively. Following detailed evaluation, $l = 60\text{cm}$ was adopted, and the observation angles (α) were varied from 15° to 55° in increments of 5° . The resulting parameters H and D , provided in Table 5.2, are within reasonable limits. To ensure sufficient measurements configurations, the chosen CIE angles configurations are summarized as below:

- α : ranging from 15° to 55° in increments of 5° ;
- β : $0^\circ, 10^\circ, 30^\circ, 50^\circ, 70^\circ, 90^\circ, 110^\circ, 130^\circ, 150^\circ, 160^\circ, 165^\circ, 170^\circ$;
- γ : $0^\circ, 10^\circ, 15^\circ, 20^\circ, 25^\circ, 30^\circ, 35^\circ, 40^\circ, 45^\circ, 50^\circ, 55^\circ, 60^\circ, 65^\circ, 70^\circ, 75^\circ, 80^\circ$;

- δ : 0° .

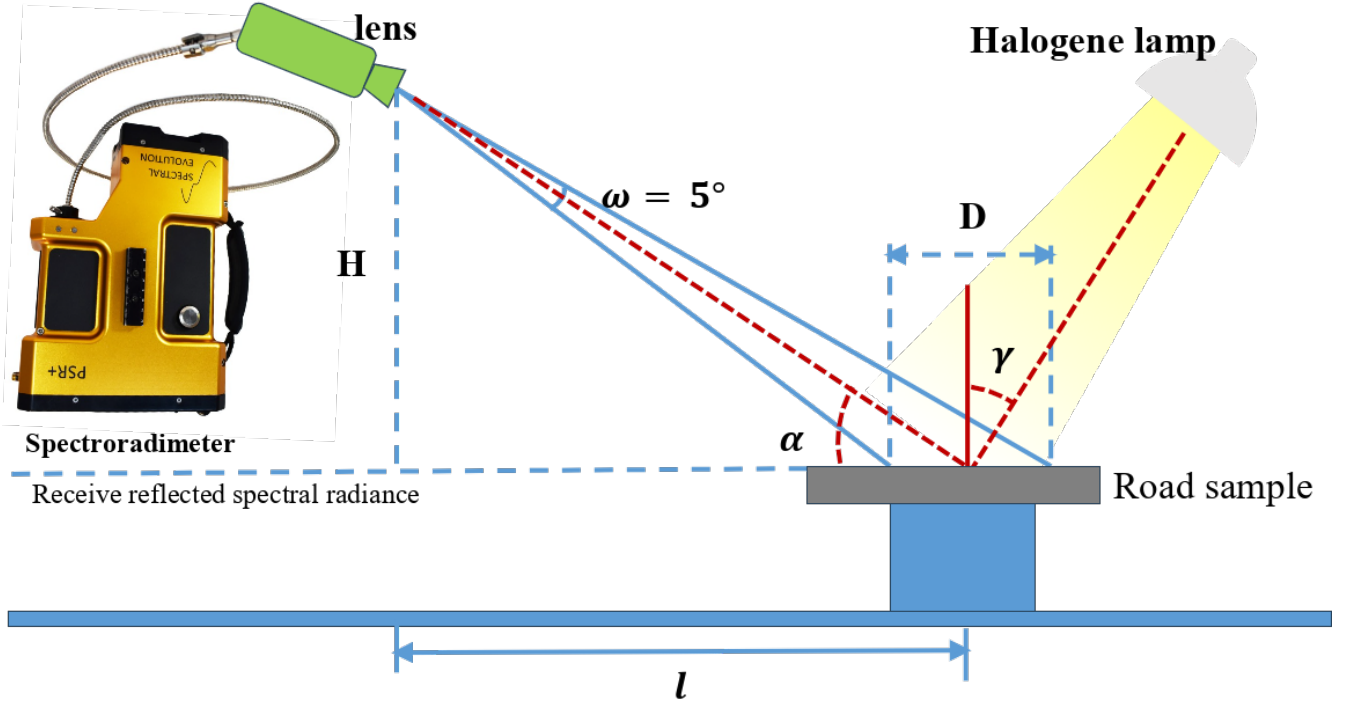


Figure 5.10: Complete Gonio-spectroradiometer set-up (Cerema)

According to the definition of BRDF, it is expressed a function of 4 angles ($\theta_i, \phi_i, \theta_r, \phi_r$) in the spherical coordinate system. Therefore, it is necessary to convert the CIE standard angles ($\alpha, \beta, \gamma, \delta$) into the corresponding spherical angles [41]:

$$\begin{aligned}
 \theta_i &= \gamma \\
 \phi_i &= \delta - \beta [2\pi] \\
 \theta_r &= \pi/2 - \alpha \\
 \phi_r &= \delta + \pi [2\pi]
 \end{aligned} \tag{5.1}$$

Accordingly, the spherical angles $\theta_i, \phi_i, \theta_r, \phi_r$ are:

- θ_i (16 values): $0^\circ, 10^\circ, 15^\circ, 20^\circ, 25^\circ, 30^\circ, 35^\circ, 40^\circ, 45^\circ, 50^\circ, 55^\circ, 60^\circ, 65^\circ, 70^\circ, 75^\circ, 80^\circ$;
- ϕ_i (1 value): $360^\circ, 350^\circ, 330^\circ, 310^\circ, 290^\circ, 270^\circ, 250^\circ, 230^\circ, 210^\circ, 200^\circ, 195^\circ, 190^\circ$;
- θ_r (9 values): ranging from 35° to 75° with a step of 5°
- ϕ_r (12 values): 180°

Table 5.2: Configuration parameters for $l = 60cm$

α	H (cm)	D (cm)
15°	16.08	18
20°	21.84	14.6
25°	27.98	12.5
30°	34.64	11.2
35°	42.01	10.5
40°	50.35	10.1
45°	60	10
50°	71.51	10.3
55°	85.69	10.8

This results in a total of 1728 ($= 16 \times 1 \times 9 \times 12$) measurements configurations for each samples. Assuming that all samples are isotropic, the angles ϕ_i and ϕ_r can be interchanged, allowing observation of the BRDF distribution over the hemispherical space for a given incident direction (θ_i, ϕ_i) . Owing to the symmetric emission pattern of the halogen lamp, the BRDF at the symmetric angle of ϕ_r can be obtained from that at ϕ_r . Thus the new spherical angles $\theta_i, \phi_i, \theta_r, \phi_r$ for measurements becomes:

- θ_i (16 values): $0^\circ, 10^\circ, 15^\circ, 20^\circ, 25^\circ, 30^\circ, 35^\circ, 40^\circ, 45^\circ, 50^\circ, 55^\circ, 60^\circ, 65^\circ, 70^\circ, 75^\circ, 80^\circ$;
- ϕ_i (1 value): 180° ;
- θ_r (9 values): ranging from 35° to 75° with a step of 5°
- ϕ_r (24 values): $0^\circ, 10^\circ, 30^\circ, 50^\circ, 70^\circ, 90^\circ, 110^\circ, 130^\circ, 150^\circ, 160^\circ, 165^\circ, 170^\circ, 190^\circ, 195^\circ, 200^\circ, 210^\circ, 230^\circ, 250^\circ$

In reality, although only 1728 measurements are required, this process yields 3456 measured data points. As know, the BRDF represents the ratio of reflected radiance to incident irradiance, requiring both quantities to be measured separately. The incident irradiance at normal incidence ($\theta_i = 0^\circ$) over the wavelength range of $350nm$ to $2500nm$, is first measured using a calibrated diffuser. For oblique incident angles, the corresponding irradiance estimated by scaling the normal-incident irradiance by the cosine of the incidence angle $\cos \theta_i$. This cosine dependence is experi-

mentally verified by comparing the measured flux at various incidence angles θ_i with the predicted flux, calculated as the normal-incident flux $F_{\theta_i=0}$ multiplied by $\cos \theta_i$. The comparison is shown in Table 5.3. Notice that the relative error is the ratio between the absolute difference of the measured and predicted fluxes and the measured flux. With θ_i ranging from 0° to 80° , the relative deviation remains below 5%, confirming the validity of the cosine law. When θ_i exceeds 80° , the light source becomes nearly coplanar with the sample surface. Due to the conical emission profile of the light source (Halogen lamp), the measured flux does not vanish as θ_i approaches 90° . For this reason, measurements at incident angles greater than 80° were excluded to maintain measurement reliability. After obtaining the incident irradiance, the focus shifts to the measurements of the reflected radiance for all selected samples.

Table 5.3: Measured flux F_{θ_i} at different θ_i vs measured normal-incident flux $F_{\theta_i=0}$ multiplied by $\cos \theta_i$

θ_i	Measured flux F_{θ_i}	Normal-incident flux $F_{\theta_i=0}$ multiplied by $\cos \theta_i$	Relative error
0°	532.0	532.0	0.0%
20°	508.0	499.9	1.6%
40°	415.0	407.5	1.8%
60°	267.0	266.0	0.4%
65°	222.6	224.8	1.0%
70°	181.3	182.0	0.4%
80°	96.7	93.4	3.4%
82°	82.1	74.0	10.0%
84°	67.3	55.6	17.4%
86°	54.1	37.1	31.4%
88°	42.3	18.6	56.0%
90°	31.4	0.0	100.0%

In order to obtain accurate and reliable measurements of spectral radiance(step: 1-2-3-4-6-7-8) or irradiance (step: 1-2-3-4-5-7-8), the procedure is as follows:

1. Turn on the halogen lamp and let it warm up 25 minutes to generate stable radiation;
2. Turn on the goniometer, the computer connected it and the software controlling it;
3. Turn on the spectroradiometer, the computer connected it and the software used to record the spectral irradiance or radiance;
4. Verify good connection between the lens and spectroradiometer;
5. When measuring irradiance, place the diffuser at the center of the sample holder and adjust the height of the sample holder, ensuring that its surface is aligned horizontally with both the halogen lamp at $\theta_i = 90^\circ$ and the camera at $\theta_r = 90^\circ$;
6. When measuring radiance,
 - place the test sample on the center of the sample holder and adjust the height of sample holder, ensuring that its surface is aligned horizontally with both the halogen lamp at $\theta_i = 90^\circ$ and the camera at $\theta_r = 90^\circ$;
 - adjust the position of the lens, ensuring it is aligned vertically with both camera and the sample holder;
 - adjust the height of the lens to correspond to the given configuration angle θ_r ;
7. Launch the codes to start the measurements for all given angles configurations $(\theta_i, \phi_i, \theta_r, \phi_r)$;
8. Let the software automatically record the irradiance or radiance;

Having both measured irradiance and radiance, we can compute the spectral BRDF for each sample.

5.2.3 Validation on a calibrated reflectance target

The first validation is to compare the measured BRDF of spectralon with its theoretical BRDF. The Spectralon is a white surface which has near-perfect Lambertian behavior. For a given diffuse albedo ρ_d , its BRDF can be computed as:

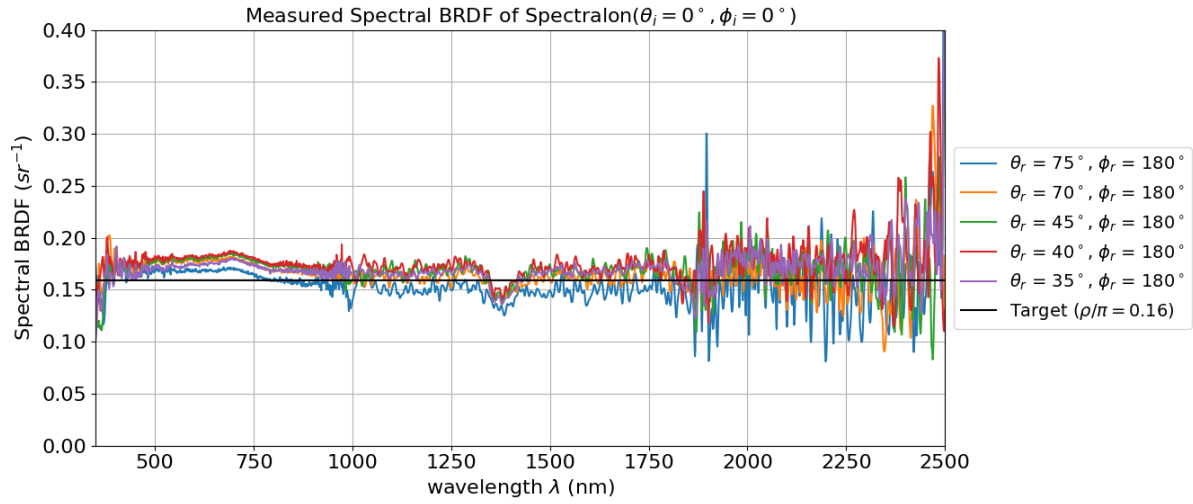
$$f_r(\theta_i, \phi_i, \theta_r, \phi_r, \lambda) = \frac{\rho_d}{\pi} \quad (5.2)$$

Figure 5.11(a) shows the measured BRDF of Spectralon with a diffuse albedo of 0.5 at incident normal direction from 350 to 2500nm, considering different observation angles. The measured BRDF exhibits noticeable fluctuations along with wavelength, particularly in the near-infrared region. To better understand how far from measured data to the expected BRDF of Spectralon which is $\rho/\pi = 0.16$, the relative errors at each wavelength are calculated and displayed in Figure 5.11(b). In the visible range, relative errors remain below 20%, while in the near-infrared region they are generally below 60%, with larger variations observed. Overall, the results show consistency with the expected behavior between 500nm and 1725nm, confirming the accuracy and reliability of the proposed measurement method.

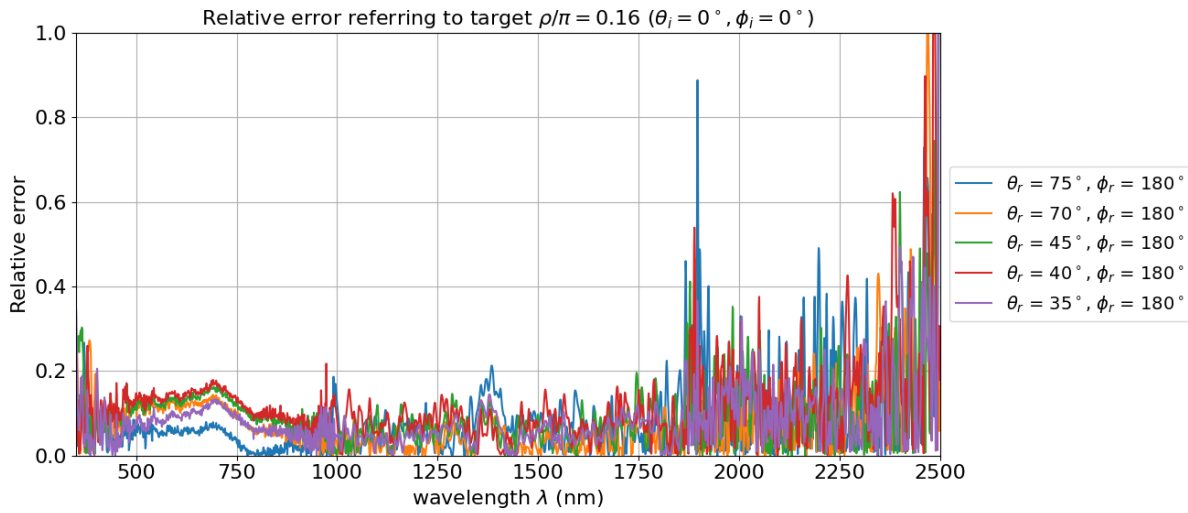
5.2.4 Validation by comparison with measurements conducted by UGE

The second validation is performed by comparing the BRDF measurements obtained using our method with those acquired by Université Gustave Eiffel (UGE). Since the BRDF data provided by UGE are photometric, our measured spectral BRDF must be converted into a corresponding photometric BRDF for comparison. To achieve this, the measured irradiance E_λ and radiance L_λ within the visible range (360–830nm) have to be transformed into illuminance E_{vis} and luminance L_{vis} respectively, using the conversion equations (see Equation (2.4)) provided by CIE. In this validation, we compare the photometric BRDF of two samples: F2 and Lazard 6/10. At UGE, measurements were conducted for 3000 configurations, while at Cerema, 1728 configurations were measured. Only the 193 configurations common to both datasets were used for direct comparison, as shown in Table 5.4

Figures 5.12(a) and 5.13(a) illustrate the comparison, with blue dots representing the BRDF measured at UGE and orange dots representing measurements from Cerema. Some discrepancies between the two datasets are evident for certain configurations. To quantify these differences, the relative error with respect to the UGE measurements is calculated, as shown in Figures 5.12(b) and 5.13(b). For sample F2, the relative difference ranges from 0 to 0.35, with 73% of configurations exhibiting less than 10% difference. For Lazard 6/10, the relative difference ranges from 0 to 0.3, with over 96% of configurations showing less than 10% difference. The relative error of sample F2 is lower than that of sample lazard 6/10 across the 193 common configurations. This occurs

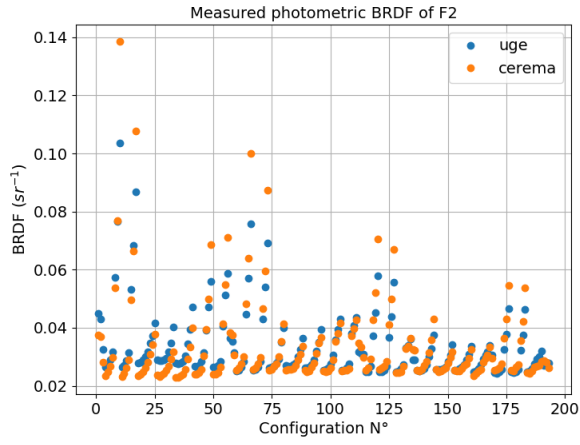


(a) Measured spectral BRDF of Spectralon with diffuse albedo $\rho = 0.5$

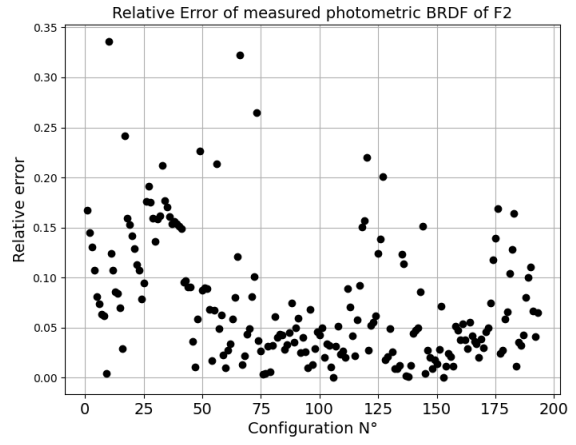


(b) Relative error referring to expected BRDF of Spectralon ($\rho/\pi = 0.16$)

Figure 5.11: Results of Spectralon

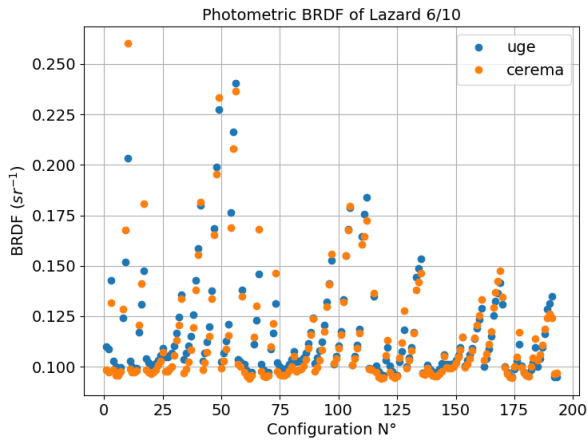


(a) Photometric BRDF

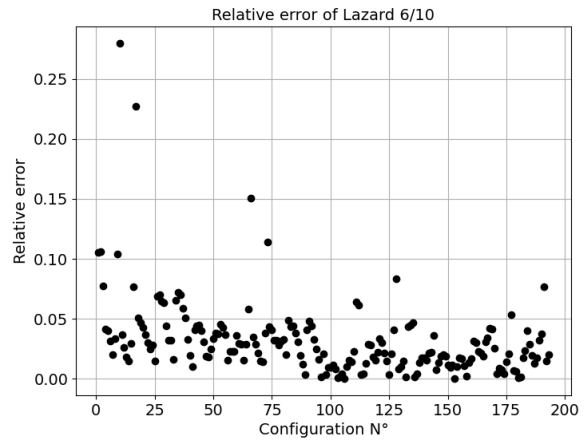


(b) Relative error

Figure 5.12: F2: comparison between UGE and Cerema



(a) Photometric BRDF



(b) Relative error

Figure 5.13: Lazard 6/10: comparison between UGE and Cerema

because the BRDF values of sample F2 are generally lower, so an equivalent absolute deviation results in a proportionally larger relative error. Overall, our measurements show good agreement with those from UGE for most configurations. However, larger discrepancies are observed at high incident angles ($\theta_i = 80^\circ$) and large reflection angles ($\theta_r > 60^\circ$). These differences are likely caused by direct light entering the lens due to the close horizontal positioning of the light source and the lens, combined with the conical nature of the illumination. As a result, part of the incident light is directly captured by the detector, increasing the measured BRDF relative to the UGE reference and leading to higher relative errors in these affected configurations.

5.3 Results

5.3.1 Measured spectral BRDF of 5 samples from 350–2500nm

For each measurement configuration characterized by the spherical angles $\theta_i, \phi_i, \theta_r, \phi_r$, the spectral BRDF values are determined over the wavelength range from 350nm to 2500nm. Figure 5.14 illustrates the measured BRDF for a particular incident direction ($\theta_i = 60^\circ, \phi_i = 180^\circ$) under both forward ($\theta_r = 60^\circ, \phi_r = 0^\circ$) and backward ($\theta_r = 60^\circ, \phi_r = 165^\circ$) observation geometries. Across all samples, the BRDF values exhibit a monotonic increase within the visible range, followed by pronounced oscillations in the infrared region. Notably, in the forward direction, the BRDF values of F2, mastic F2, and mastic F3 are consistently higher than in the backward direction, whereas F3 and Lazard 6/10 display the opposite trend. Lazard 2/6 shows only minor directional dependence. Comparison across samples reveals that single-component Lazard samples exhibit higher BRDF values than F2 and F3 composites in both the visible and infrared ranges, irrespective of observation direction. In the backward direction, mastic F3 and mastic F2 have lower BRDF values than their respective base materials (F3 and F2), while in the forward direction, the opposite trend is observed. This effect is particularly pronounced for mastic F3, which shows a substantial forward–backward asymmetry, indicative of strong specular reflection behavior.

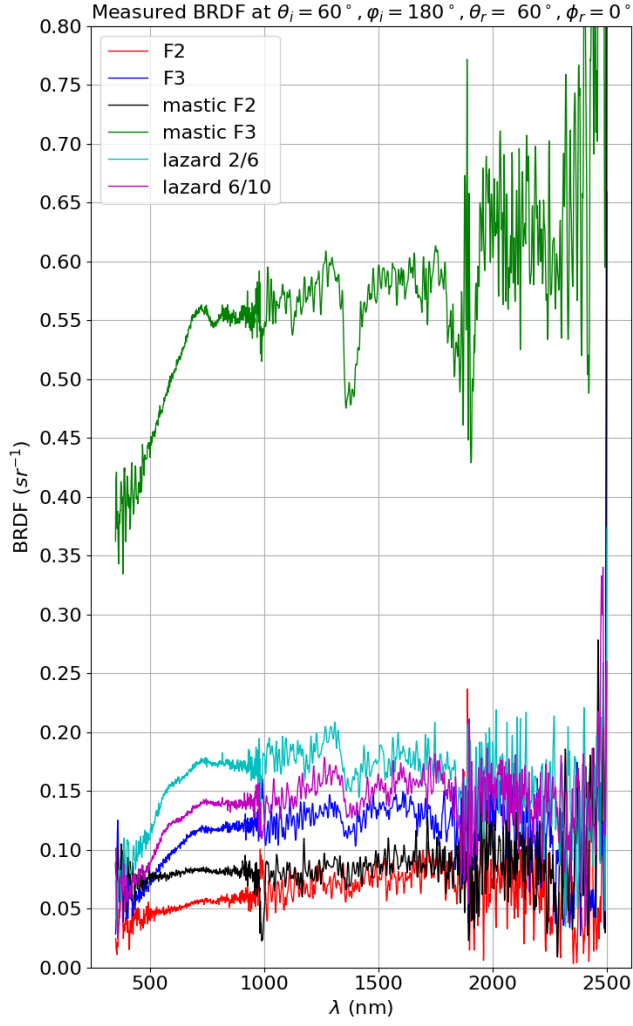
5.3.2 Visualization of BRDF over hemisphere

To explore specular and retro reflections for all these samples, their BRDF distributions in whole hemisphere for a given incident direction ($\theta_i = 60^\circ, \phi_i = 180^\circ$) are visualized in Figure 5.15, considering a wavelength of $600nm$ within the visible range. Owing to constraints of the measurement environment, the data corresponding to observation geometries with $\theta_r < 35^\circ$ and $\theta_r > 75^\circ$ could not be acquired, resulting in a missing region (“hole”) in the BRDF distributions of all samples. Inspection of the distributions reveals pronounced specular reflections in all samples, particularly for mastic F2 and mastic F3, consistent with the previously observed higher BRDF values compared to F2 and F3, respectively. In addition, retro-reflective features are evident in F2, F3, and Lazard samples of both sizes. Notably, F3 and the Lazard samples exhibit similar BRDF distribution patterns, showing stronger retro-reflection relative to specular reflection. Conversely, F2, mastic F2, and mastic F3 demonstrate the opposite behavior, where specular reflection dominates over retro-reflection.

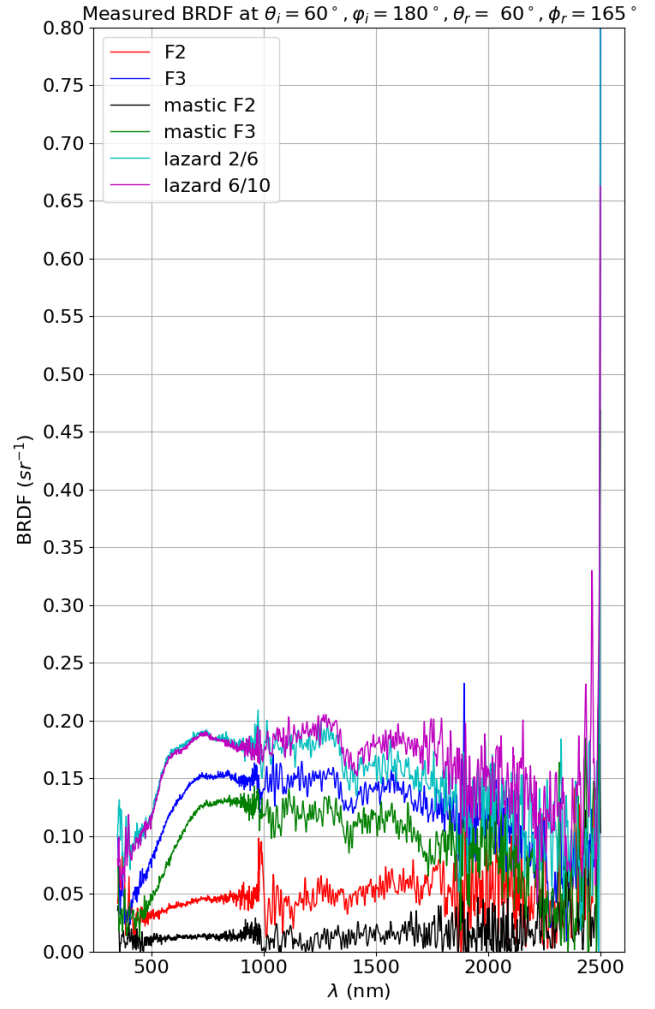
5.3.3 Impact of binder

As mentioned previously, F2 is composed of lazard 2/6, lazard 6/10 and mastic F2, while F3 consists of the same aggregates combined with mastic F3. To better understand the relationship between the BRDF values of F2 and F3 and those of their individual components, a cross-sectional cut of the BRDF distribution at $\theta_r = 60^\circ$ for each sample was extracted, as illustrated in Figure 5.16. For both F2 and F3, the BRDF values remain below those of their components except at the specular direction. This observation motivates an investigation into whether the BRDF of F2 or F3 can be represented as a linear or nonlinear combination of the BRDFs of their constituent components.

In both the full mixtures and the corresponding mastics, the only differing component is the binder: F2 and mastic F2 contain a synthetic binder, whereas F3 and mastic F3 use bitumen. As seen in Figure 5.17, both F2 and mastic F2 has lower BRDF values comparing to F3 and mastic F3, respectively. This consistent difference indicates that the binder has a significant contribution in governing the reflective behavior of multi-component road materials. The lower BRDF values

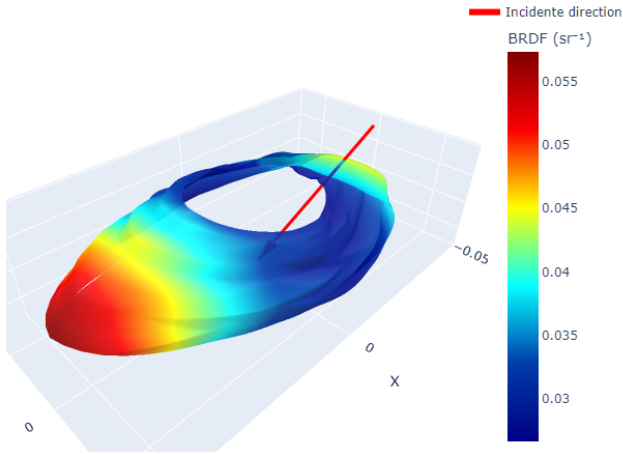


(a) $\theta_r = 60^\circ, \phi_r = 0^\circ$

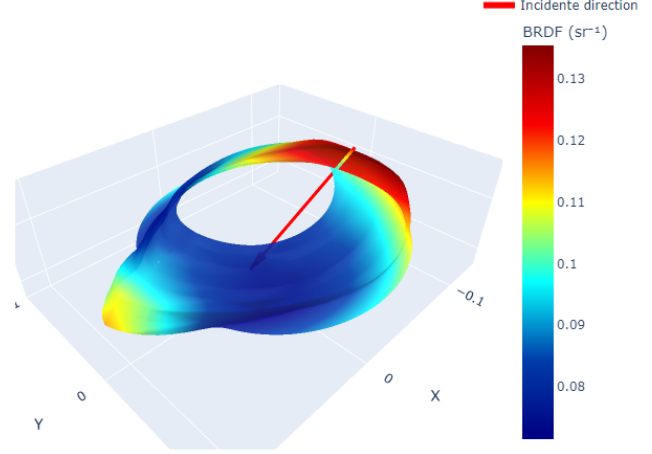


(b) $\theta_r = 60^\circ, \phi_r = 165^\circ$

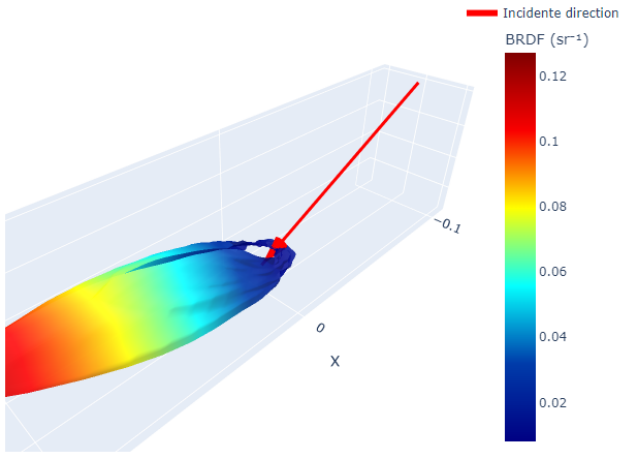
Figure 5.14: Measured spectral BRDF at $\theta_i = 60^\circ, \phi_i = 180^\circ$ from 350nm to 2500nm



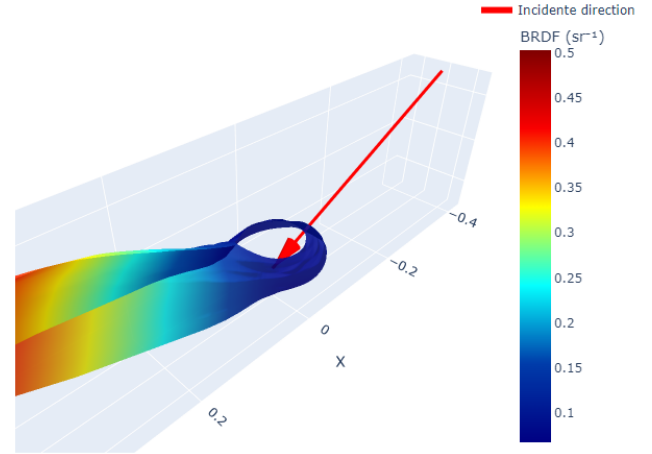
(a) F2



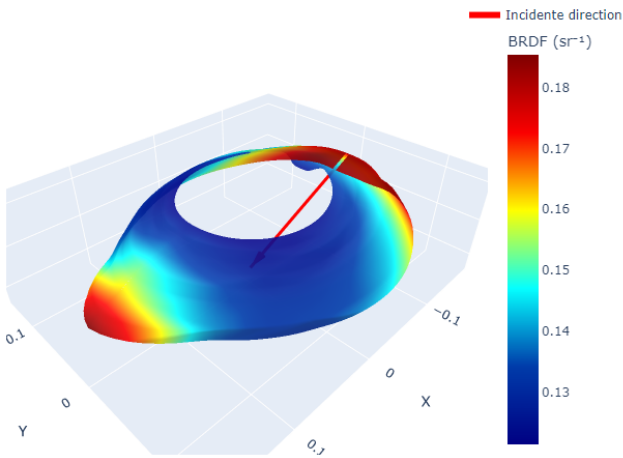
(b) F3



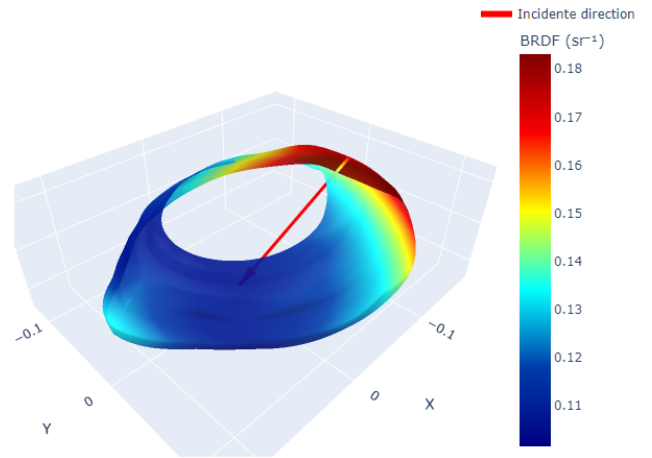
(c) Mastie F2



(d) Mastie F3



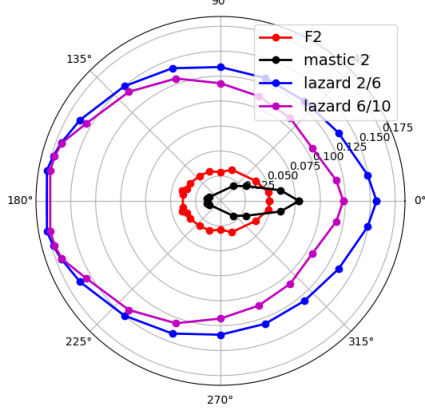
(e) Lazard 2/6



(f) Lazard 6/10

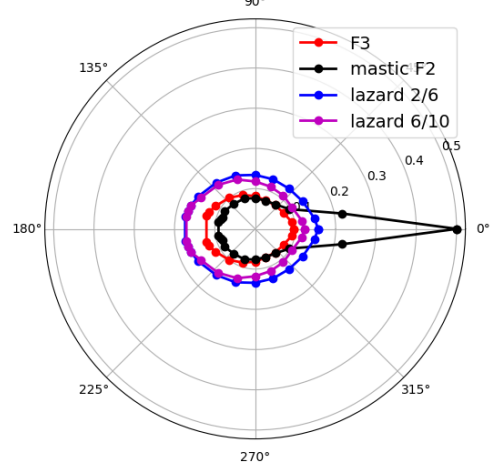
Figure 5.15: BRDF distribution at $\theta_i = 60^\circ$, $\phi_i = 180^\circ$ for $\lambda = 600\text{nm}$

Measured BRDF at $\lambda = 600nm$ ($\theta_i = 60^\circ$, $\phi_i = 180^\circ$, $\theta_r = 60^\circ$)



(a) F2 and its components

Measured BRDF at $\lambda = 600nm$ ($\theta_i = 60^\circ$, $\phi_i = 180^\circ$, $\theta_r = 60^\circ$)



(b) F3 and its components

Figure 5.16: Measured spectral BRDF distribution at $\theta_i = 60^\circ$, $\phi_i = 180^\circ$, $\theta_r = 60^\circ$ for $\lambda = 600nm$ for F2, F3 and their components

observed in bitumen-based mixtures suggest that bitumen reduced surface reflectivity, likely due to its dark color and so low reflectivity property.

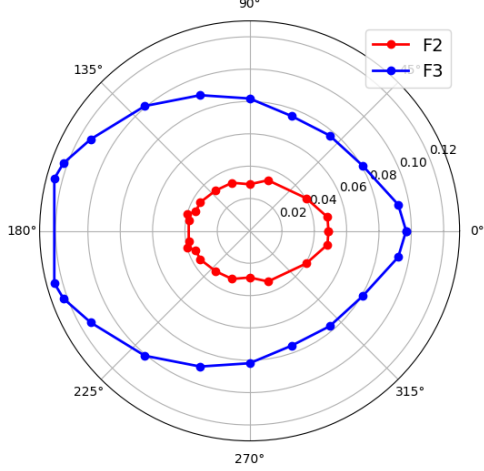
5.3.4 Impact of aggregates' size

From the BRDF distributions of the Lazard samples with two sizes at $600nm$ shown in Figure 5.15(e) and Figure 5.15(f), no significant differences are observed between them across observation configurations, except near the specular direction. Similar behavior can be also observed in Figure 5.16. This suggests that aggregate size primarily affects the BRDF in the specular region. The smaller aggregates exhibit slightly higher BRDF values than the larger ones, which may be attributed to the higher proportion of bright mineral particles exposed at the surface.

5.4 Conclusion

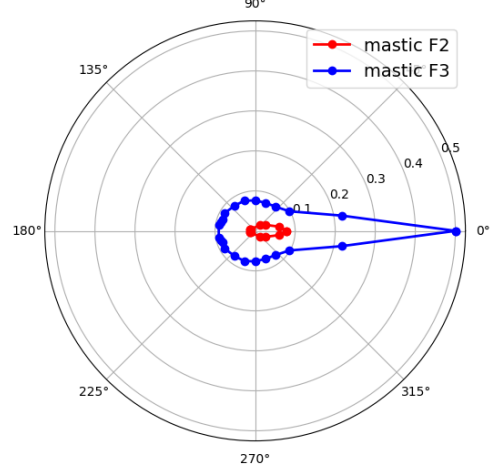
Both validations using spectralon with albedo of 0.5 and comparing measured data to the ones measured by UGE, prove that the proposed spectral BRDF measurement approached shows a good accuracy. For the study of spectral BRDF of roads surface, we conduct many measurements on the multi-material roads and their components. The data demonstrates that the binder has

Measured BRDF at $\lambda = 600\text{nm}$ ($\theta_i = 60^\circ$, $\phi_i = 180^\circ$, $\theta_r = 60^\circ$)



(a) F2 vs F3

Measured BRDF at $\lambda = 600\text{nm}$ ($\theta_i = 60^\circ$, $\phi_i = 180^\circ$, $\theta_r = 60^\circ$)



(b) Mastic F2 vs Mastic F3

Figure 5.17: Measured spectral BRDF comparison

a significant contribution on the BRDF behavior of the mixture roads. Besides, the aggregates with different size has few difference except at the specular direction, which may have different contribution on the BRDF of mixture at the specular direction.

In future work, the measured spectral BRDF data can be used to calibrate and evaluate existing reflectance models, such as the Cook Torrance model [26], the Oren Nayar model [20], and the Ashikhmin Shirley model [27]. Furthermore, it will be of interest to develop a hybrid model that combines the most appropriate BRDF models for each material component to represent the BRDF of composite road surfaces. This can provide a foundation for predicting the spectral BRDF of more complex pavement materials.

Table 5.4: 193 common configurations

Configuration N°	α	β	γ
1-3	15°	0°, 10°, 170°	45°
4-10	20°	0°	0°, 10°, 20°, 30°, 60°, 70°, 80°
11-17	20°	10°	0°, 10°, 20°, 30°, 60°, 70°, 80°
18-25	20°	50°	0°, 10°, 20°, 30°, 45°, 60°, 70°, 80°
26-33	20°	90°	0°, 10°, 20°, 30°, 45°, 60°, 70°, 80°
34-41	20°	130°	0°, 10°, 20°, 30°, 45°, 60°, 70°, 80°
42-49	20°	160°	0°, 10°, 20°, 30°, 45°, 60°, 70°, 80°
50-56	20°	170°	0°, 10°, 20°, 30°, 60°, 70°, 80°
57-59	25°	0°, 10°, 170°	45°
60-66	30°	0°	0°, 10°, 20°, 30°, 60°, 70°, 80°
67-73	30°	10°	0°, 10°, 20°, 30°, 60°, 70°, 80°
74-80	30°	50°	0°, 10°, 20°, 30°, 45°, 70°, 80°
81-88	30°	90°	0°, 10°, 20°, 30°, 45°, 60°, 70°, 80°
89-96	30°	130°	0°, 10°, 20°, 30°, 45°, 60°, 70°, 80°
97-104	30°	160°	0°, 10°, 20°, 30°, 45°, 60°, 70°, 80°
105-111	30°	170°	0°, 10°, 20°, 30°, 60°, 70°, 80°
112-114	35°	0°, 10°, 170°	45°
115-120	40°	0°	0°, 10°, 30°, 60°, 70°, 80°
121-127	40°	10°	0°, 10°, 20°, 30°, 60°, 70°, 80°
128-134	40°	170°	0°, 10°, 20°, 30°, 60°, 70°, 80°
135-136	45°	0°, 10°	45°
137-144	45°	50°	0°, 10°, 20°, 30°, 45°, 60°, 70°, 80°
145-152	45°	90°	0°, 10°, 20°, 30°, 45°, 60°, 70°, 80°
153-160	45°	130°	0°, 10°, 20°, 30°, 45°, 60°, 70°, 80°
161-168	45°	160°	0°, 10°, 20°, 30°, 45°, 60°, 70°, 80°
169	45°	170°	45°
170-176	50°	0°	0°, 10°, 20°, 30°, 60°, 70°, 80°
177-183	50°	10°	0°, 10°, 20°, 30°, 60°, 70°, 80°
184-190	50°	170°	0°, 10°, 20°, 30°, 60°, 70°, 80°
191-193	50°	0°, 10°, 170°	45°

Chapter 6

Conclusion and Perspectives

6.1 Conclusion

Both validations using spectralon with albedo of 0.5 and comparing measured data to the ones measured by UGE, prove that the proposed spectral BRDF measurement approached shows a good accuracy. For the study of spectral BRDF of roads surface, we conduct many measurements on the multi-material roads and their components. The data demonstrates that the binder has a significant contribution on the BRDF behavior of the mixture roads. Besides, the aggregates with different size has few difference except at the specular direction, which may have different contribution on the BRDF of mixture at the specular direction.

6.2 Perspectives

In future work, the measured spectral BRDF data can be used to calibrate and evaluate existing reflectance models, such as the Cook Torrance model [26], the Oren Nayar model [20], and the Ashikhmin Shirley model [27]. Furthermore, it will be of interest to develop a hybrid model that combines the most appropriate BRDF models for each material component to represent the BRDF of composite road surfaces. This can provide a foundation for predicting the spectral BRDF of more complex pavement materials.

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